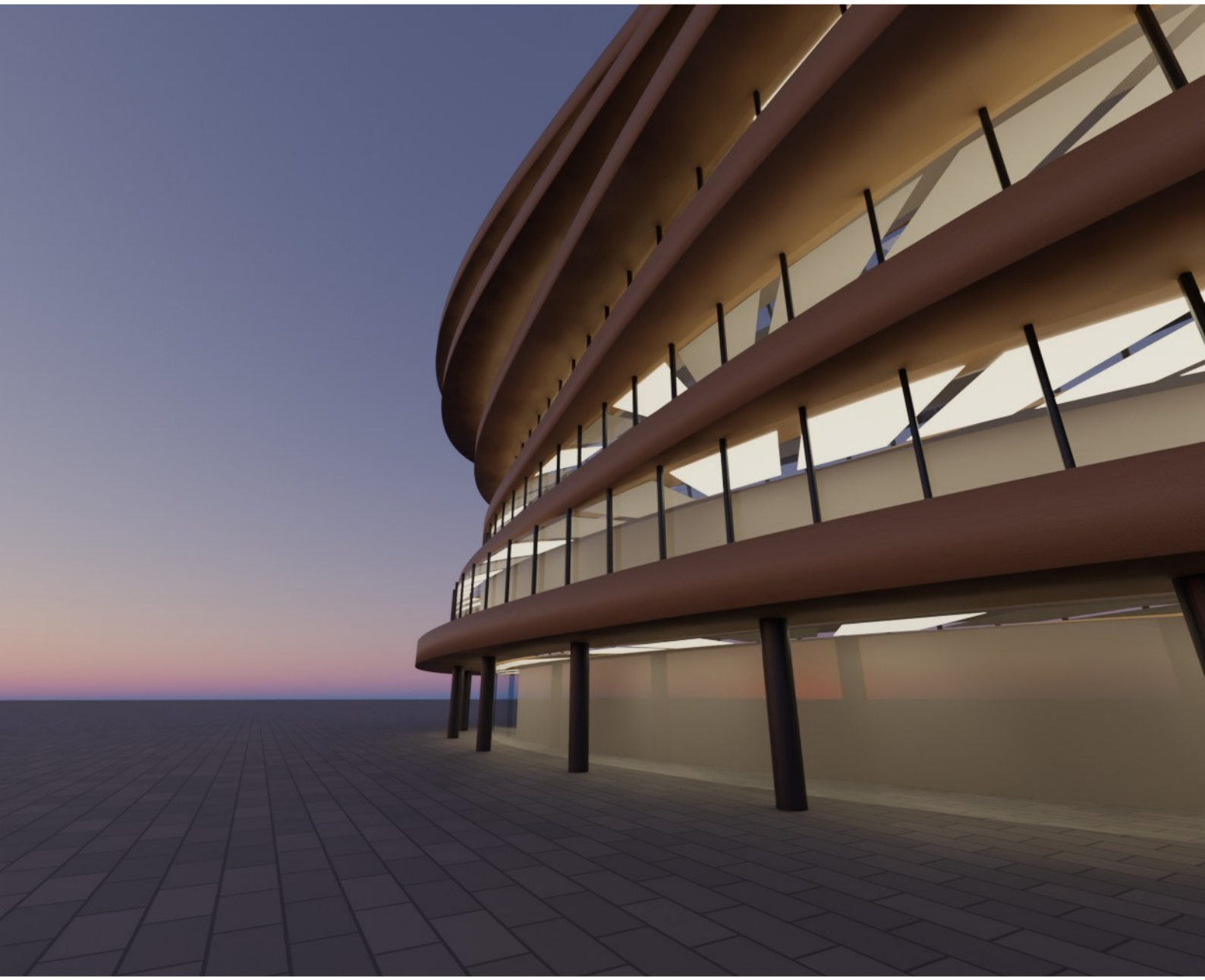
BIMopen user manual



BIMopen
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BIMopen user manual

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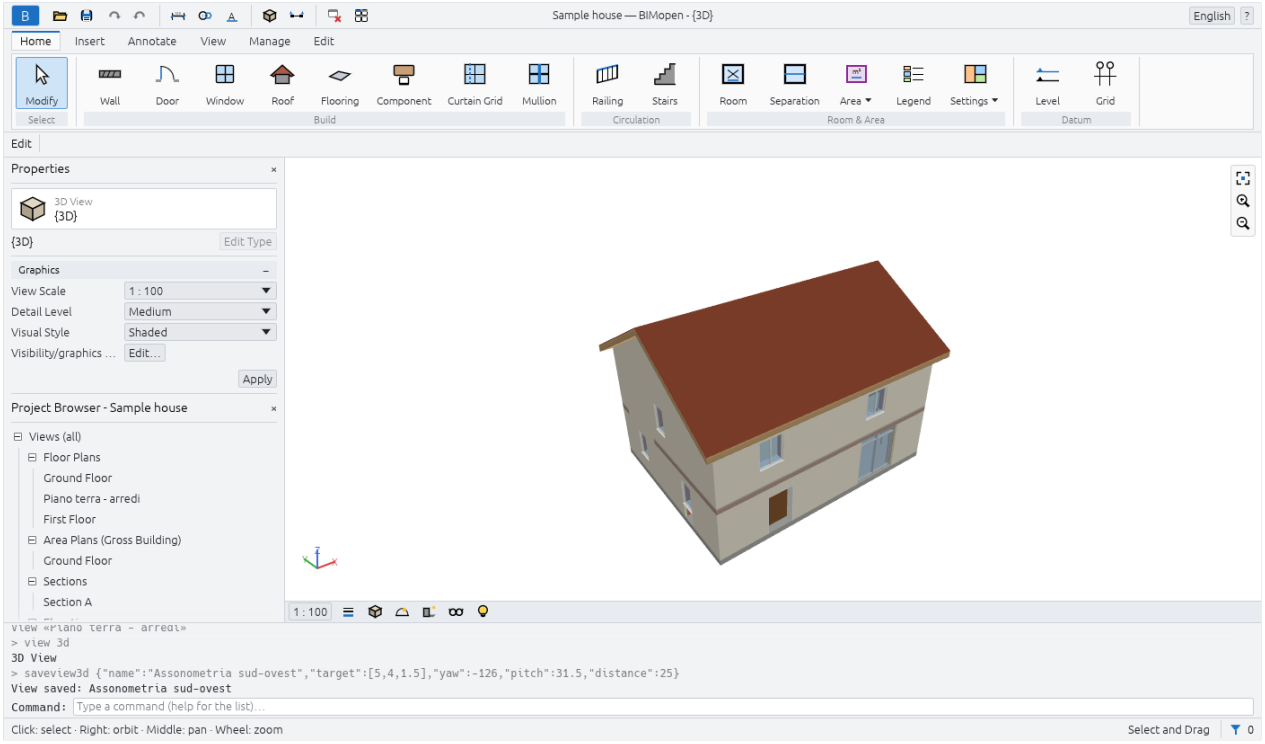
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BIMopen user manual

BIMopen is an open-source application for building information modelling (BIM). You model the building with walls, doors, windows, floors, roofs, stairs and rooms, and the drawings come from the model: plans, sections, elevations, 3D views, schedules and sheets are views of the same model and change together when you edit it.

BIMopen runs on the desktop (Linux, Windows, macOS) and in a web browser, and it can be driven from a command line and by AI agents over MCP. Its interface speaks six languages: Italian, English, German, French, Spanish and Arabic, the last one written from right to left.



How this manual is organised

Chapter	What it covers
Getting started	Installing and starting BIMopen, the sample project, and a first small house from an empty project to a sheet
The interface	The application menu, the quick access toolbar, the ribbon, the options bar, Properties, the Project Browser, the drawing area, the status bar, the command line and how to move around in the views
Projects and files	Opening, saving, exporting and importing projects
Selecting and modifying	Selecting elements and the Modify tools
Walls, doors and windows	The building envelope and its openings
Floors, roofs, stairs and components	Floors, roofs, stairs, railings, curtain walls and placed components
Views and graphics	Plans, sections, elevations, 3D views and how they are drawn
Annotation and 2D details	Dimensions, text, tags, rooms, areas and 2D details
Sheets, schedules and printing	Sheets, schedules, printing and project settings
Command line and MCP	Typing commands, `bimopen-cli` and the MCP server for agents
Keyboard shortcuts	Every key and typed shortcut
Troubleshooting	What to do when something does not work as expected

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The chapters from *Projects and files* to *Sheets, schedules and printing* are being written area by area: each one is completed when the features it describes have been checked one by one through the interface. Until then they list what they will contain.

Conventions

- Names of the interface are written in **bold**, as they appear on the screen in English: **Home** tab, **Wall** button, **Properties** palette.
- A path through the interface is written with arrows: **Home ▸ Build ▸ Wall** means the **Home** tab of the ribbon, its **Build** panel, its **Wall** button.
- Keys are written like `Ctrl+Z`; a shortcut typed at the keyboard, letter by letter, is written in capitals, like `WA`.
- Commands typed at the command line, and their output, are written `like this`. Points are `x,y` in metres.
- Notes, tips and warnings are set apart:

> **Note**
>
> A note adds something worth knowing.

> **Tip**
>
> A tip shows a quicker or better way.

> **Warning**
>
> A warning tells you about something that can lose work or give a wrong result.

What this manual describes

This manual describes BIMopen as it is today, and only what has been tried in the program. When a feature is not described yet, it may still exist: the roadmap *(https://atsanna.github.io/bimopen-site/roadmap.html)* lists what is available and what is planned. The whole manual is also a PDF, one per language: the last entry of the navigation, **PDF**, downloads it.

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Getting started

This chapter shows how to start BIMopen on the desktop and in the browser, what the sample project contains, and how to model a first small house: four walls, a door, a window, a floor, a roof, a 3D view and a sheet with the plan on it. It takes about ten minutes.

Running BIMopen on the desktop

BIMopen is built from its source code with Rust, version 1.90 or later. On Linux the graphical interface also needs the development files of xkbcommon, Wayland and GTK 3.

```
sudo apt-get install -y libxkbcommon-dev libwayland-dev libgtk-3-dev   # Debian, Ubuntu
cargo run --release -p bimopen -- --sample                             # opens the sample house
```

The program is `bimopen`. It accepts a file to open and one option:

Command	What it opens
`bimopen`	A new, empty project
`bimopen --sample`	The sample house
`bimopen house.bimopen`	The project saved in `house.bimopen`

You can also open a project by dragging a `.bimopen` file from the file manager into the window.

Language and theme

The first time, BIMopen speaks the language of the operating system when it is one of its six languages (Italian, English, German, French, Spanish, Arabic), and English otherwise. To change it, use the language menu at the right end of the title bar (the globe with the language's name), or **Application menu ▸ Options ▸ Language**. The interface changes at once.

In **Options** you also choose the **Theme**, **Light** or **Dark**, and whether the background of the views is inverted (**Invert background color**: dark views with light lines). Choosing the dark theme also inverts the background; you can turn it back off. BIMopen remembers the language and the theme for the next time.

Running BIMopen in the browser

The web version is the same program, compiled for the browser. Open atsanna.github.io/bimopen-site/app/ *(https://atsanna.github.io/bimopen-site/app/)*: it starts with the sample house. Nothing needs to be installed, and the project stays in your browser: it is not sent anywhere.

The address accepts these options, which can be combined with `&`:

Address	Effect
`app/?lang=de`	Opens in German for this visit (`it`, `en`, `de`, `fr`, `es`, `ar`)
`app/?empty`	Starts with a new, empty project instead of the sample
`app/?webgl`	Draws with WebGL2 even where WebGPU is available

The browser must support WebGPU or WebGL2. In the browser some things work differently:

- **Open…** cannot show a file dialog: drag a `.bimopen` file into the page to open it;
- **Save** and the exports download the file, with the name of the project.

To build the web version yourself:

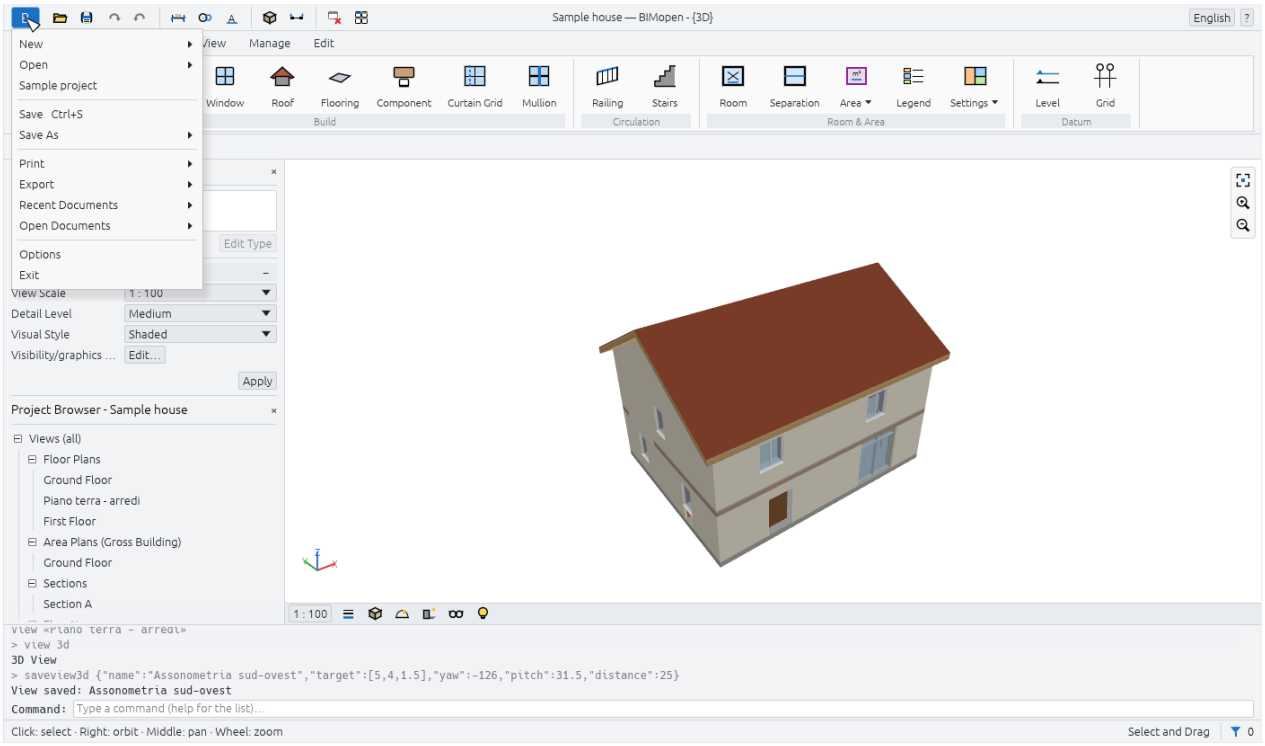
```
cargo xtask web                          # builds dist/web
python3 -m http.server 8080 -d dist/web  # then open http://localhost:8080
```

`cargo xtask web` needs the `wasm32-unknown-unknown` target of Rust and the `wasm-bindgen` command of the version written in `Cargo.lock`; with binaryen's `wasm-opt` installed, the result is smaller.

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The sample project

The sample house shows most of what BIMopen can do. Open it with **Application menu ▸ Sample project**, with `bimopen --sample`, or by typing `sample` at the command line.



It contains:

- two levels, each with its floor plan, and five grid lines;
- fifteen walls of four types, with layers, joined at the corners;
- six doors and twelve windows, tagged in the plans;
- two floors, a pitched roof, a stair with its railings and a storefront curtain wall;
- furniture and plumbing fixtures, eight rooms coloured by use, with a legend;
- a section, an elevation, an area plan, a saved 3D view and a drafting view with a wall detail;
- dimensions, text notes and the schedules of walls, doors, windows, rooms and materials.

> **Tip**
>
> The sample is a good place to try a tool before using it on your own project: a new sample is always one click away, and nothing you change in it is saved unless you save it.

Your first house

The steps below start from an empty project and end with a sheet. Every step names the button to click; the interface chapter explains each part of the window.

1. Start a new project

1. Click the blue **B** button at the left end of the title bar: the **application menu** opens.
2. Click **New ▸ Project...**. The **New project** dialog proposes BIMopen's default template: click **OK**.

The new project has two levels, **Ground Floor** and **First Floor**, a floor plan for each, and the default 3D view. It has no walls yet. Its wall, door, window, floor and roof types are ready to use.

2. Open the ground floor plan

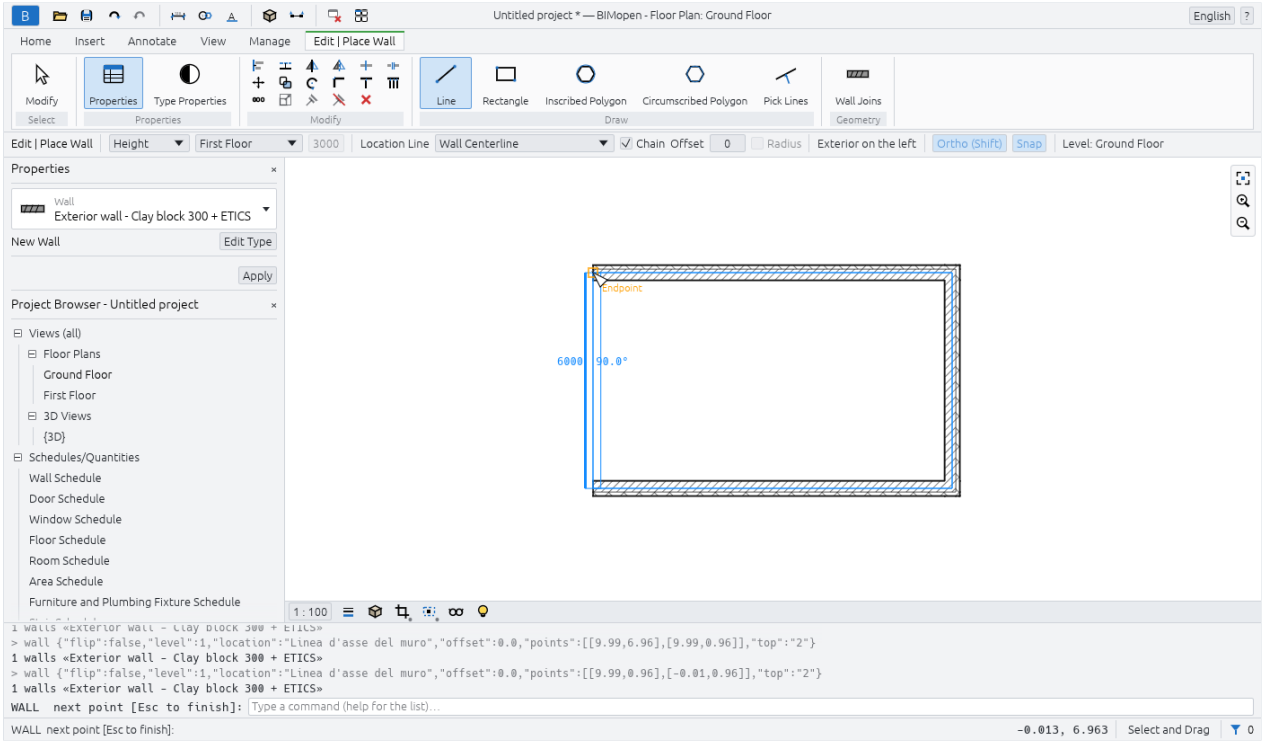
In the **Project Browser**, under **Views (all) ▸ Floor Plans**, double-click **Ground Floor**. The plan opens in the drawing area and the title bar shows **Floor Plan: Ground Floor**.

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> **Note**
>
> A single click on a view in the Project Browser shows its properties in the **Properties** palette without opening it. A double-click opens it.

3. Draw four walls

1. Click **Home ▸ Build ▸ Wall**. The ribbon switches to the contextual tab **Edit | Place Wall**, the options bar shows the settings of the wall, and **Properties** shows the type of the next wall, **Exterior wall - Clay block 300 + ETICS**.
2. On the options bar, turn on **Ortho (Shift)**: the walls stay horizontal or vertical.
3. Click in the plan where the first corner goes. The command line asks for the next point: `WALL next point [Esc to finish]:`.
4. Click the second, third and fourth corners. While you move the mouse, the length and the angle of the wall being drawn are shown next to it.
5. Click the first corner again: the four walls are joined at the corners.
6. Press `Esc` to stop the chain, and `Esc` again to end the tool.



> **Tip**
>
> You can draw the same walls by typing their corners in metres: `wall 0,0 10,0 10,6 0,6 c`. The final `c` closes the chain. See Command line and MCP.

4. Add a door and a window

1. Click **Home ▸ Build ▸ Door**, then click on a wall where the door goes. The door is placed in the wall, which is cut around it. The command line confirms it: `Door «Single swing door 80x210» in wall …`.
2. Press `Esc`: the tool ends and the ribbon returns to the **Home** tab.
3. Click **Home ▸ Build ▸ Window**, click on another wall, and press `Esc`.

A door or a window can only be placed in a wall: after a click away from the walls, the command line answers `no wall at that point` and nothing is placed.

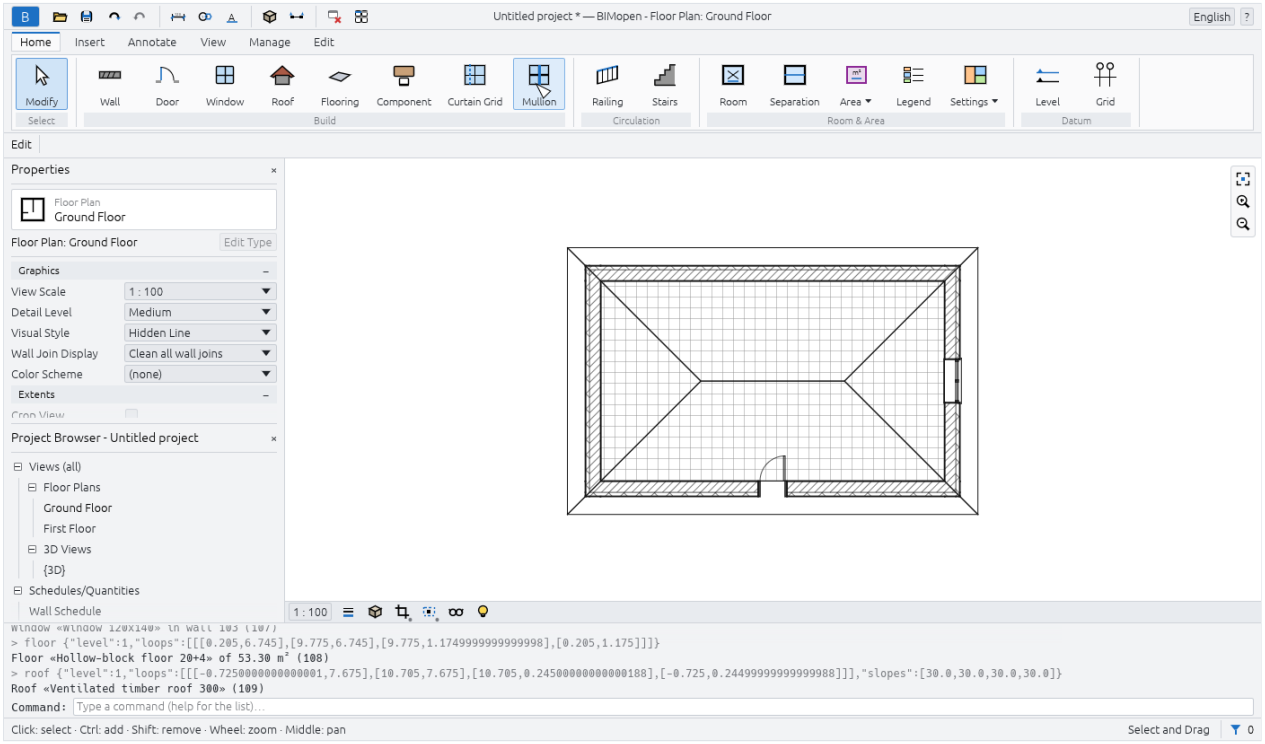
5. Add a floor and a roof

1. Click **Home ▸ Build ▸ Flooring**. Sketch mode opens: the contextual tab **Edit | Create Floor Boundary**, with **Pick Walls** active.
2. Move the cursor over a wall and press `Tab`: the four walls are highlighted. Click: their lines go on the inner faces of the walls.
3. Click **Finish Edit Mode**: the floor is made and the command line gives its area.
4. Click **Home ▸ Build ▸ Roof**. **Pick Walls** is active again; the options bar has **Defines Slope** (ticked) and the **Overhang** (500 mm by default).

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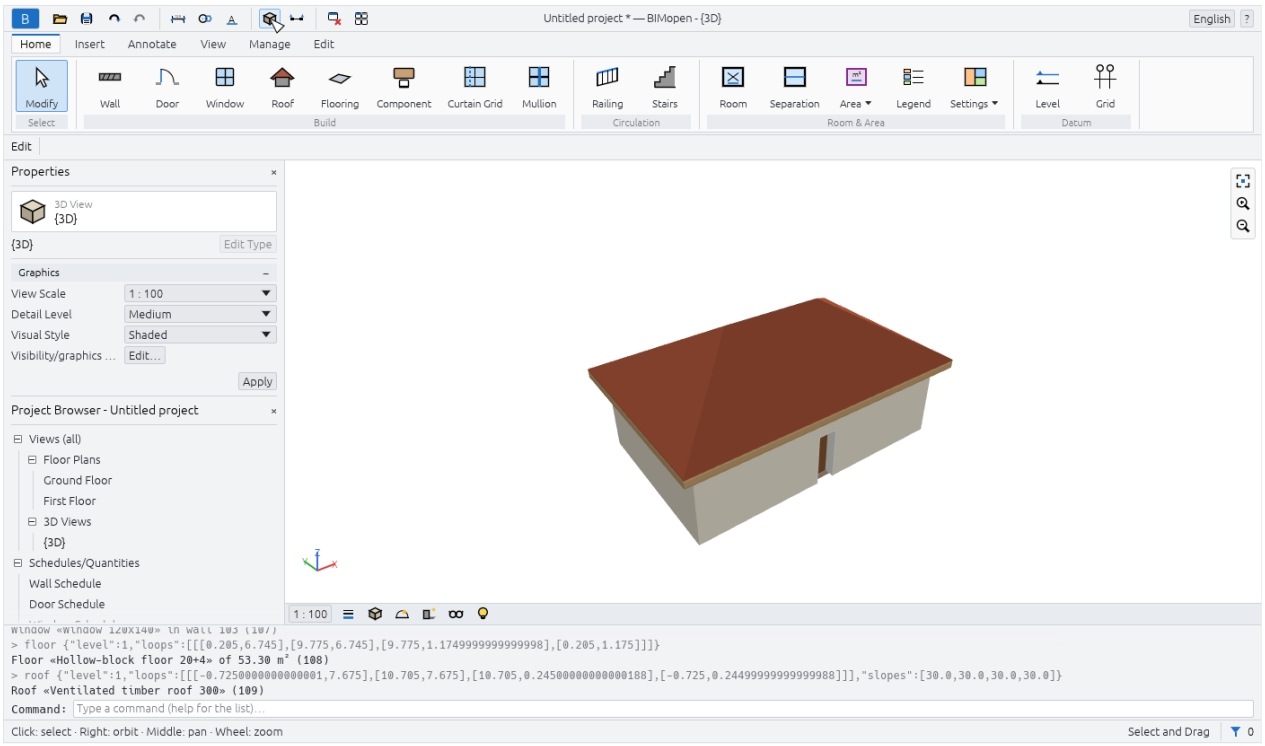
5. Press `Tab` over a wall, click, then **Finish Edit Mode**: a hip roof sloping at 30° covers the walls, with the overhang all around.

Floors, roofs, stairs and components tells more about sketch mode.



6. Look at it in 3D

Click the **3D View** button (the cube) on the quick access toolbar. The default 3D view, **{3D}**, opens. Drag with the right mouse button (or with `Shift` and the middle button) to orbit, drag with the middle button to pan, and turn the wheel to zoom; the left button selects, as in plans. `Home` fits the whole model in the view.

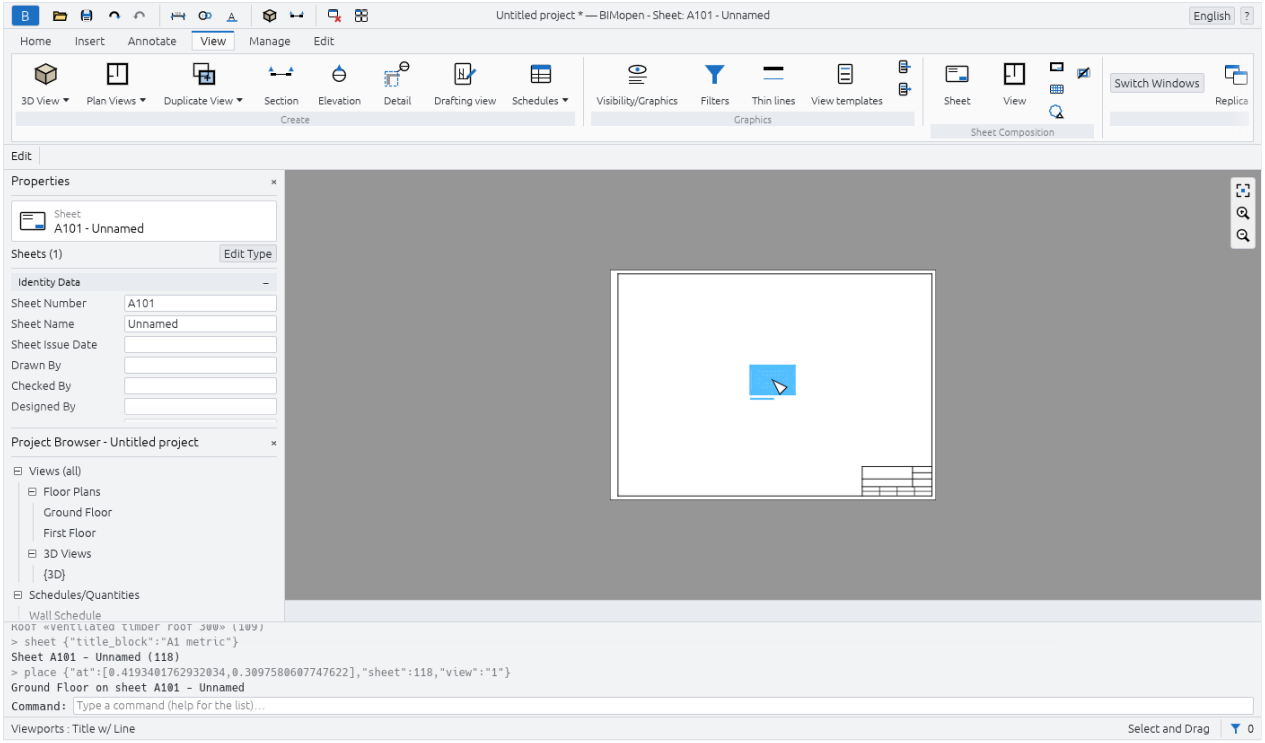


7. Put the plan on a sheet

1. Click the **View** tab, then **Sheet Composition ▸ Sheet**. The **New Sheet** dialog lists the title blocks: none, A0, A1, A2 or A3, with their size in millimetres.
2. Click **OK**. The sheet is created with the next free number (**A101** for the first one, then **A102**...) and opens.

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3. Click **Sheet Composition ▸ View**. The **Views** dialog lists the views that are not on a sheet yet.
4. Choose **Floor Plan: Ground Floor** and click **Add View to Sheet**. A rectangle of the plan's size follows the cursor: click on the sheet where the plan goes. It is placed at its own scale, 1 : 100, as a viewport, which stays selected.



8. Undo, redo and save

- `Ctrl+Z` undoes the last change (here, the viewport goes away); `Ctrl+Y` redoes it. The arrows of the quick access toolbar do the same.
- `Ctrl+S` saves the project. A project that has never been saved asks for a file name first; the file has the extension `.bimopen`. In the browser, the file is downloaded.

The title bar shows an asterisk after the project's name while there are unsaved changes: **Untitled project ***.

What next

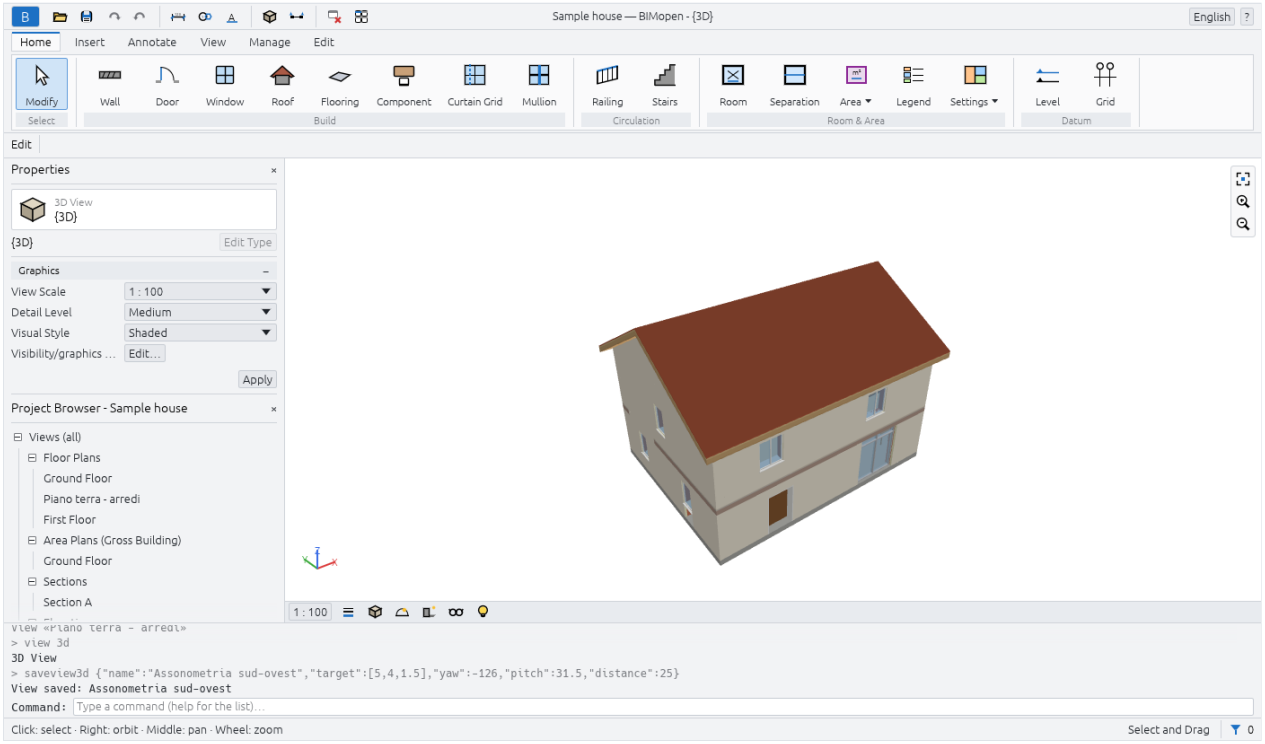
- The interface describes every part of the window.
- Keyboard shortcuts lists the keys and the two-letter shortcuts, such as `WA` for a wall.
- Command line and MCP shows how to type commands, run scripts and let an agent model for you.

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The interface

The BIMopen window has the same parts in the desktop and in the web version. From top to bottom:

1. the **title bar**, with the application menu, the quick access toolbar, the name of the project and of the active view, the language menu and the help menu;
2. the **ribbon**, with its tabs and panels of tools;
3. the **options bar**, with the settings of the active tool;
4. on the left, the **Properties** palette above the **Project Browser**;
5. the **drawing area**, where the views open in windows, each with its view control bar;
6. the **command line**, with the log of what has been done;
7. the **status bar**.

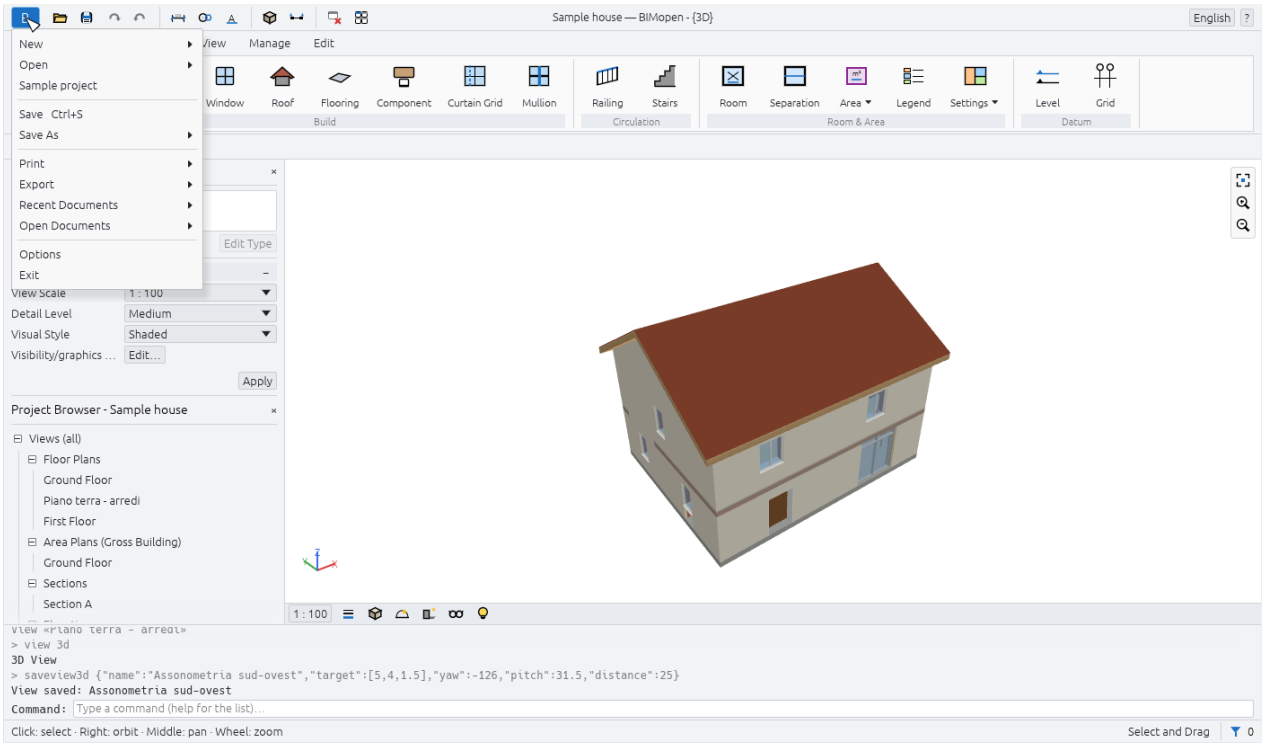


In Arabic the whole window is mirrored: the palettes are on the right, the ribbon and the options bar read from right to left, and the navigation bar is on the left edge of the views.

Application menu

The blue **B** button at the left end of the title bar opens the application menu: the commands that work on the whole project.

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Item	What it does
New	Closes the current project and starts a new one from the default template: two levels with their plans, and the default types
Open...	Opens a `.bimopen` project, or imports an `.rvt` model, chosen in a file dialog. In the browser, drag the file into the page instead
Sample project	Opens the sample house
Save `Ctrl+S`	Saves the project in its file; a project never saved asks for a name, like **Save As...**
Save As...	Saves the project in a new `.bimopen` file and goes on working on that file
Print... `Ctrl+P`	Prints sheets to PDF
Export ▸ Export IFC4...	Writes the model as an IFC4 file
Export ▸ Export plan SVG...	Writes the active plan as an SVG drawing
Export ▸ Export view PNG...	Writes the active view as a PNG image
Open Documents	Lists the open view windows; click one to bring it to the front
Options	Opens the **Options** dialog
Exit	Closes BIMopen (desktop only)

New, **Open...** and **Sample project** replace the current project without asking: save it first if you want to keep it.

> Warning
>
> Unsaved changes are lost when you choose **New**, **Open...** or **Sample project**. The asterisk after the project's name in the title bar tells you that there are unsaved changes.

Options

Application menu ▸ Options has two groups:

Setting	Values	Effect
User Interface ▸ Language	Italiano, English, Deutsch, Français, Español, العربية	The language of the whole interface, at once

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Setting	Values	Effect
User Interface ▸ Theme	**Light**, **Dark**	The colours of the window. **Dark** also turns on **Invert background color**
Graphics ▸ Invert background color	on, off	Views with a dark background and light lines

BIMopen remembers the language and the theme the next time it starts.

Quick access toolbar

Next to the application menu, the quick access toolbar keeps the most used commands one click away. Rest the mouse on a button to read what it does and its shortcut.

Button	What it does
Open… (folder)	As in the application menu
Save (disk)	Saves, `Ctrl+S`
Undo (arrow left)	Undoes the last change, `Ctrl+Z`. Greyed when there is nothing to undo
Redo (arrow right)	Redoes the change just undone, `Ctrl+Y`. Greyed when there is nothing to redo
Aligned dimension	Starts the aligned dimension tool, `DI`
Tag All	Tags the doors and windows of the open plan that have no tag yet, `TG`
Text	Starts the text tool, `TX`
3D View (cube)	Opens the default 3D view, **{3D}**
Section	Starts the section tool, `SE`
Close Hidden	Closes every view window except the active one. Greyed when only one is open
Switch Windows	Lists the open view windows; the active one is ticked

In the middle of the title bar, when the window is wide enough, BIMopen shows the name of the project and of the active view, for example **Sample house — BIMopen - Floor Plan: Ground Floor**. An asterisk after the project's name means that it has unsaved changes.

At the right end:

- the **language menu**, a globe with the name of the current language: choose another one and the interface changes at once;
- the **?** menu: **Commands** lists every command at the command line (as typing `help`), and **About** shows the version, the licence and the credits.

? ▸ Help (`F1`) opens this manual, in the language of the interface, in the browser. `F1` opens the page of what you are doing: the open dialog, the ribbon button under the mouse (its tip ends with **Press F1 for more information**) or the active tool.

Ribbon

The ribbon groups the tools in tabs, and each tab in panels. The name of a panel is written under its buttons. A button whose name is followed by a small mark opens a menu. Resting the mouse on a button shows what it does and, in brackets, the shortcut you can type to start it.

Tab	Panels
Home	**Select**, **Build**, **Circulation**, **Room & Area**, **Datum**
Annotate	**Select**, **Dimension**, **Text**, **Detail**, **Tag**
View	**Create**, **Graphics**, **Sheet Composition**, **Windows**
Manage	**Settings**, **Inquiry**
Edit	The contextual tab: its panels depend on the active tool and on the selection

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The Home tab

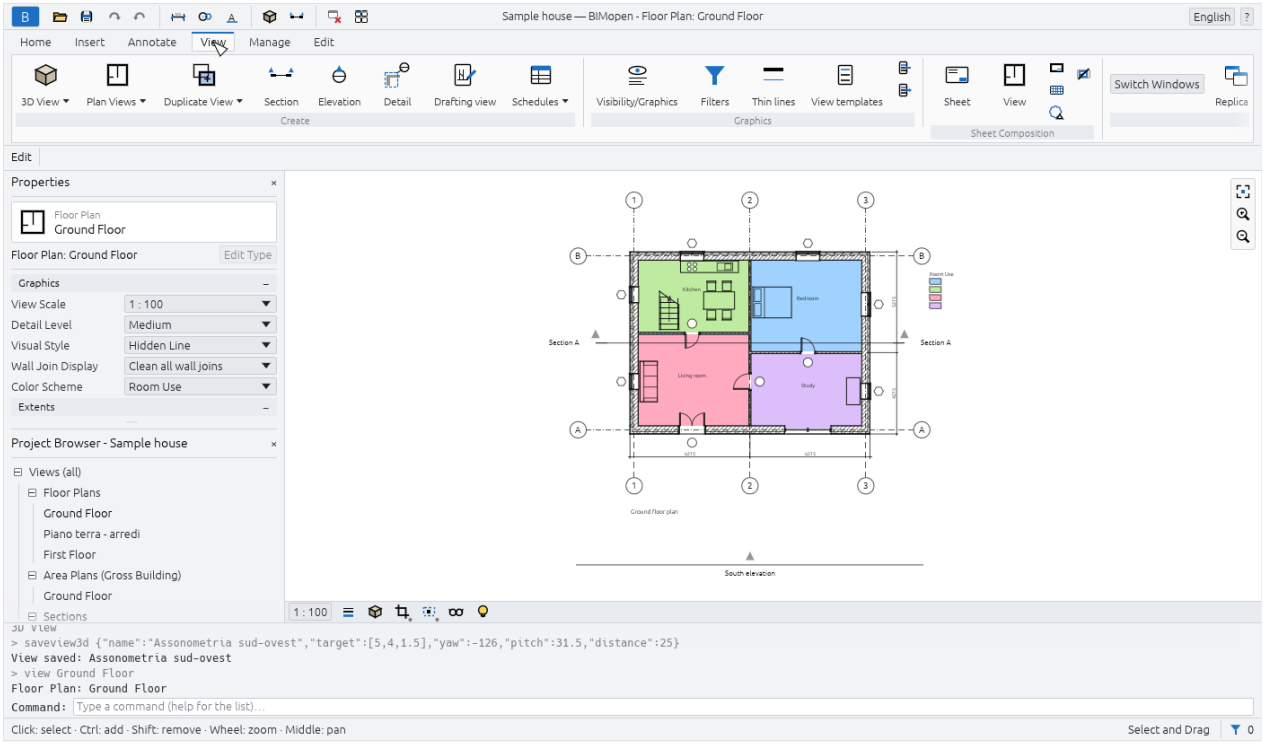
Panel	Buttons
Select	**Modify**: ends the active tool and goes back to selecting, `Esc`
Build	**Wall** `WA`, **Door** `DR`, **Window** `WN`, **Roof** `RF`, **Flooring** `SB`, **Component** `CM`, **Curtain Grid** `CG`, **Mullion** `MU`
Circulation	**Railing** `RA`, **Stairs** `ST`
Room & Area	**Room** `RM`, **Separation** `RS`, **Area** ▾ (**Area Plan**, **Area Boundary Line**, **Area**), **Legend** `LG`, **Settings** ▾ (**Area and Volume Computations**, **Color Schemes**)
Datum	**Level**: drawn in an elevation or a section, two clicks at the new level's height (from a plan it opens an elevation); **Grid** `GR`

Area Boundary Line and **Area** work in an area plan: until one is open they are greyed, and their tip says to open an area plan first.

The Annotate tab

Panel	Buttons
Select	**Modify**
Dimension	**Aligned** `DI`, **Linear** `DL`, **Angular** `DA`
Text	**Text** `TX`
Detail	**Detail line**, **Filled region**, **Masking region**, **Detail component** `CD`, **Repeating detail** `RD`, **Insulation** `IS`
Tag	**Tag All** `TG`

The View tab



Panel	Buttons
Create	**3D View** ▾ (**Default 3D View**, **Save View**), **Plan Views** ▾ (**Floor Plan**, **Area Plan**), **Duplicate View** ▾ (**Duplicate**, **Duplicate with Detailing**), **Section** `SE`, **Elevation** `EL`, **Detail** `DT` (a callout), **Drafting view** `VD`, **Schedules** ▾ (**Schedule/Quantities**, **Predefined schedules**)
Graphics	**Visibility/Graphics** `VG`, **Filters**, **View templates**, and two small buttons: **Apply template to current view**, **Create template from current view**
Sheet Composition	**Sheet**: a new sheet with the title block you choose; **View**: places a view on the open sheet

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Panel	Buttons
Windows	**Switch Windows**, **Replicate**, **Cascade**, **Tile**, **Maximize**, **Close Hidden**, **User Interface**

Save View works only while a 3D view is open, **Duplicate with Detailing** only for views that are not 3D, and **Sheet Composition ▸ View** only while a sheet is open.

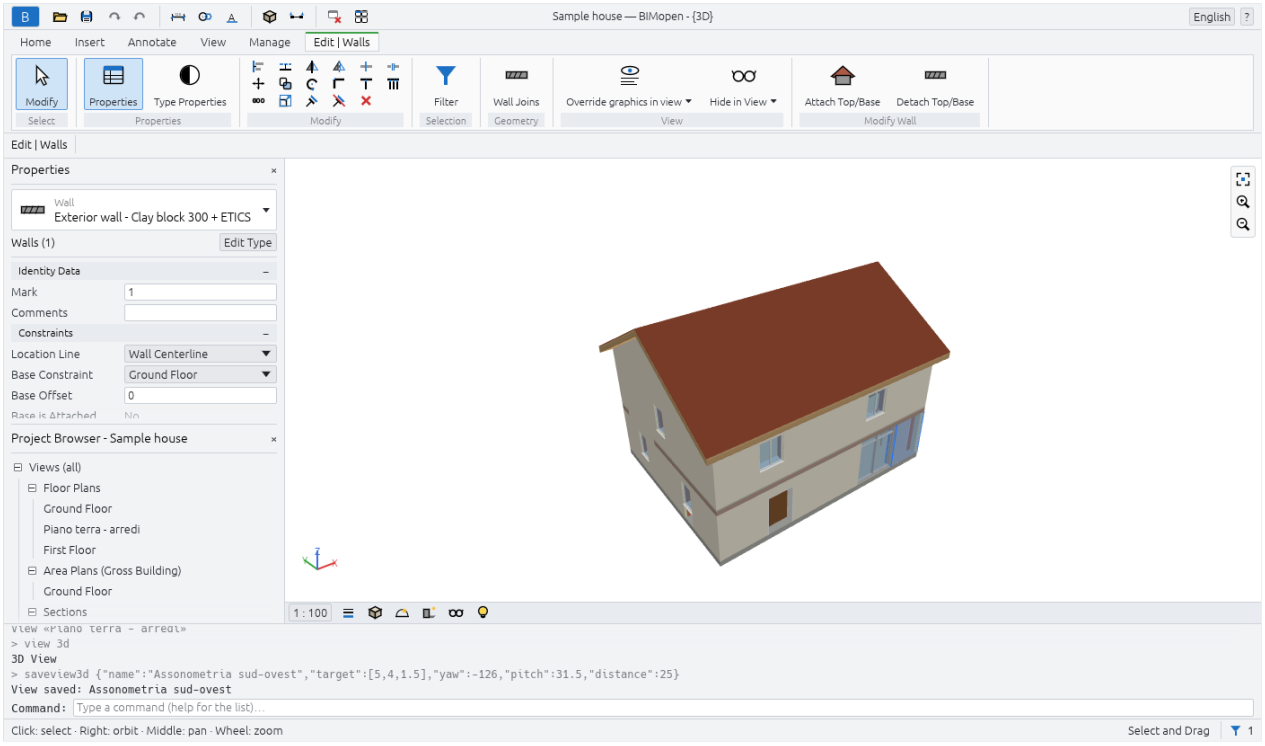
The Manage tab

Panel	Buttons
Settings	**Materials**, **Project information**, **Object styles**, **Line styles**, **Purge unused**, **Project units** `UN`, **Snap**, and **Additional settings** (**Line styles**, **Fill patterns**)
Inquiry	**Check**: checks the openings and references of the model and reports at the command line

Snap turns snapping on and off for the whole program: it is highlighted while on.

The contextual tab

When you start a tool or select something, the ribbon switches by itself to the last tab, which takes the name of what you are doing: **Edit | Place Wall** while drawing walls, **Edit | Walls** with walls selected, **Edit | Multi-Select** with elements of different categories. The tab is marked with its own colour. When the tool ends, or the selection is cleared, the ribbon goes back to the tab you were using.



It always has these panels:

Panel	Buttons
Select	**Modify**
Properties	**Properties**: shows or hides the Properties palette; **Type Properties**: the properties of the type of the selection, or of the next element the tool will place
Modify	Seventeen small tools in three rows: **Align** `AL`, **Offset** `OF`, **Mirror - Pick Axis** `MM`, **Mirror - Draw Axis** `DM`, **Split Element** `SL`, **Split with Gap** `SG`; **Move** `MV`, **Copy** `CO`, **Rotate** `RO`, **Trim/Extend to Corner** `TR`, **Trim/Extend Single Element**, **Trim/Extend Multiple Elements**; **Array** `AR`, **Scale** `RE`, **Pin** `PN`, **Unpin** `UP`, **Delete** (`Del`)

Delete works only when something is selected. The selecting and modifying chapter describes the Modify tools.

Other panels appear for what is selected or for the tool:

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When	Panel and buttons
Anything selected	**Selection**: **Filter** (see Selecting and modifying)
Doors or windows selected	**Opening**: **Flip facing**, **Flip hand**
Walls selected	**Modify Wall**: **Attach Top** (the walls rise to the roof above them), **Detach Top**
A level selected	**View**: **Open plan**
Sections or elevations selected	**Section**: **Split Segment** (sections only), **Flip**, **Go to View**
A callout selected	**Detail**: **Go to View**
Curtain walls selected	**Curtain Wall**: **Curtain Grid**, **Mullion**, **Panel**
Flooring or **Roof** tool	**Draw**: **Boundary Line**, **Pick Walls**
Stairs or **Railing** tool	**Mode**: **Finish Edit Mode**; **Draw**: **Run** or **Lines**
Mullion tool	**Placement**: **Grid Line**, **Grid Line Segment**, **All Grid Lines**
A detail tool	The drawing shapes of the tool

Options bar

Under the ribbon, the options bar starts with the name of the contextual tab, then shows the settings of the active tool. They apply to the next elements you place. At its end, while a tool is active, it shows the level you are working on: **Level: Ground Floor**.

Tool	Settings on the options bar
Wall	**Height** or **Depth**; the level the wall reaches, or **Unconnected** with its value; **Location Line**; **Chain**; **Offset**; **Radius** (greyed: curved walls are not available yet); **Exterior on the left** or **Exterior on the right** (the space bar swaps them)
Roof	The shape: **Gable**, **Hip** or **Flat**; **Slope**, from 5° to 60°; **Overhang**, up to 2 m
Stairs	**Width**, in millimetres; **Railing Type**, or **None**
Dimensions	What the cursor picks first on a wall: **Wall centerlines** or **Wall faces**
Detail (callout)	The scale of the new detail view
Area Boundary Line	**Line** or **Pick lines**; with **Pick lines**, **Apply area rules** or an **Offset**
Tools that draw lines	**Ortho (Shift)**: horizontal and vertical segments only; **Snap**: snapping to endpoints, midpoints and intersections

With **Ortho (Shift)** off, holding `Shift` while drawing gives the same constraint; with it on, `Shift` releases it.

Properties

The **Properties** palette shows and changes the parameters of what you are working on. From top to bottom it has:

- the **type selector**: the family in small letters and the type underneath. Click it to choose another type: the selected elements change type, or, while a tool is active, the next element gets that type;
- a row with what the palette is showing, for example **Walls (1)** or **New Wall**, and the **Edit Type** button, which opens the type properties;
- the parameters, in groups (**Constraints**, **Graphics**, **Identity Data**...). Click the name of a group to fold it. Values in grey are read-only: they are computed from the model;
- the **Apply** button, which confirms a value you are typing. `Enter` does the same.

What the palette shows depends on the situation:

Situation	The palette shows
Nothing selected, no tool	The properties of the active view (scale, detail level, visual style...), or of the view clicked in the Project Browser
A tool active	The type of the next element, as **New Wall**, **New Door**...
One element selected	Its type and its instance parameters

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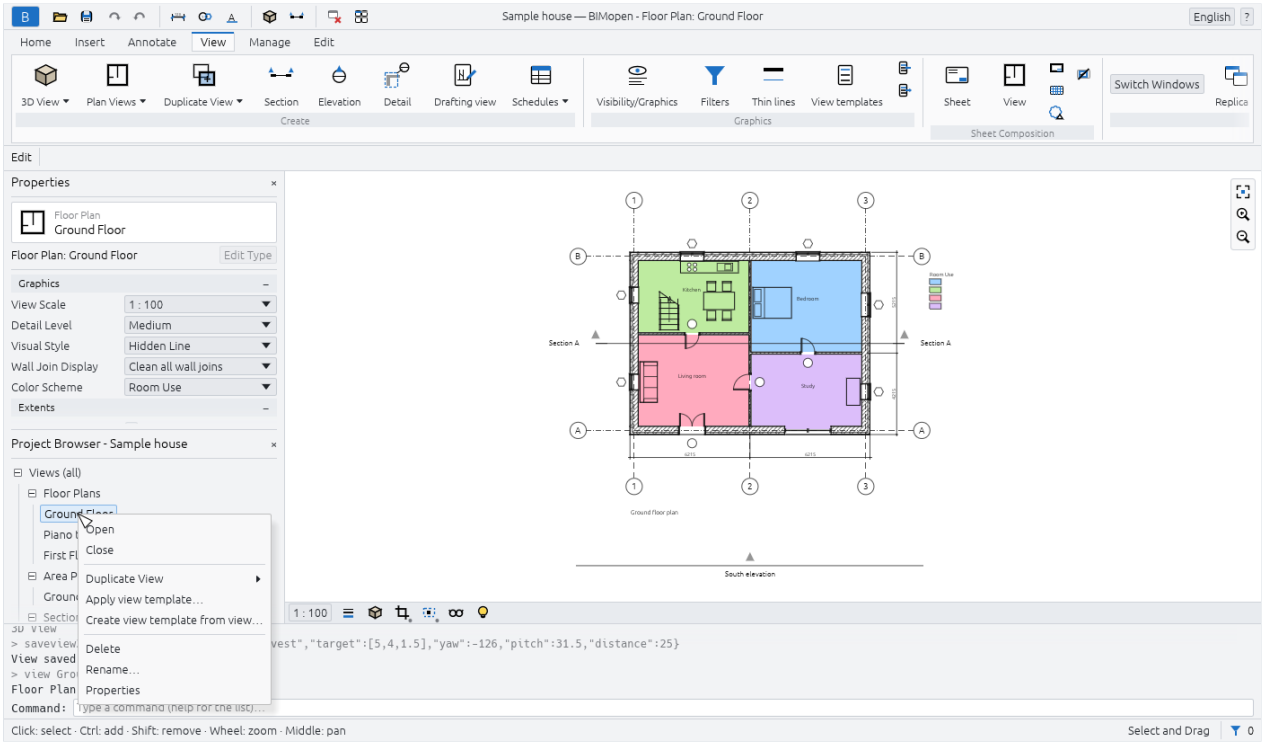
Situation	The palette shows
Several elements of one category	Their number, as **Walls (3)**
Elements of different categories	**Multi-Select**, **Common (5)**, and how many of each category, as **3 × Walls**

Lengths are written and read in the project's units (millimetres in a new project). You can type a value with its unit, for example `2.7m`.

To close the palette, click × on its title; to show it again, use **View ▸ Windows ▸ User Interface ▸ Properties** or the **Properties** button of the contextual tab.

Project Browser

The **Project Browser** lists the views, schedules, sheets and families of the project in a tree. Its title carries the name of the project. Click ⊟ or ⊞ to fold or unfold a branch.



Branch	What it contains
Views (all) ▸ Floor Plans	The floor plans of every level, from the lowest, and the callouts drawn in plans
Views (all) ▸ Area Plans (...)	The area plans, one branch per area scheme
Views (all) ▸ Sections, Elevations	The sections and the elevations
Views (all) ▸ Detail Views	The callouts drawn in sections
Views (all) ▸ 3D Views	**{3D}**, the default 3D view, and the saved 3D views
Views (all) ▸ Drafting views	The drafting views
Schedules/Quantities	The project's schedules, then the predefined schedules
Sheets (all)	The sheets, as number - name
Families	The types of the project, by category: walls, doors, windows, floors, roofs, components and the others

The branches of area plans, sections, elevations, detail views and drafting views appear only when they have something in them. The active view is written in bold.

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With a view:

- a **click** shows its properties in the Properties palette, without opening it;
- a **double-click** opens it;
- a **right-click** opens its menu: **Open**, **Close** (closes its windows), **Duplicate View ▸** (**Duplicate**, **Duplicate with Detailing**), **Apply view template...**, **Create view template from view...**, **Delete**, **Rename...**, **Properties**.

The menu of a sheet has **Apply view template to all views...** instead of the two template items, and no **Duplicate View**. **{3D}** cannot be deleted or renamed.

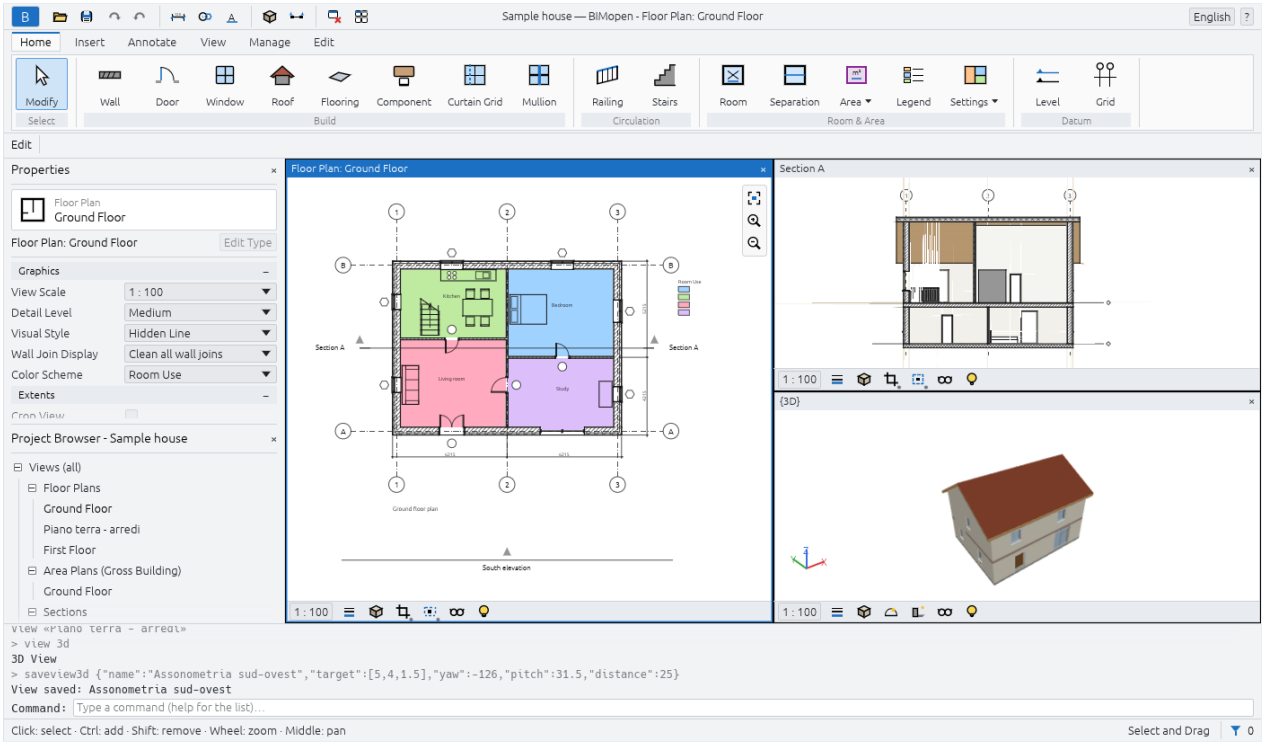
With a schedule of the project, a click selects it, a double-click opens it, and the right-click menu has **Open**, **Schedule Properties...** and **Delete**. A predefined schedule opens with a click.

With a type, under **Families**, a double-click opens its type properties; the right-click menu has **Type Properties**, **Duplicate...**, **Create Instance** (starts the tool that places it, with that type) and **Delete**.

Drawing area and view windows

Every view you open is a window in the drawing area. A view opened again comes to the front; at least one window always stays open. **View ▸ Windows** arranges them:

Button	What it does
Switch Windows	Lists the open windows; the active one is ticked
Replicate	Opens a second window on the active view, with its own zoom
Cascade	Overlapping windows, each with its title bar: drag a title to move a window, its edges to resize it
Tile	All the windows side by side, each with a title bar; the active one has a blue title and frame
Maximize	The active window fills the drawing area; the others wait underneath
Close Hidden	Closes every window except the active one
User Interface	Shows or hides the **Project Browser**, **Properties**, the **Command line**, the **Status bar** and the **Navigation bar**



Click in a window to make it active: the tools work in the active window, the others only show the model. In **Tile** and **Cascade**, the **×** on a window's title bar closes it.

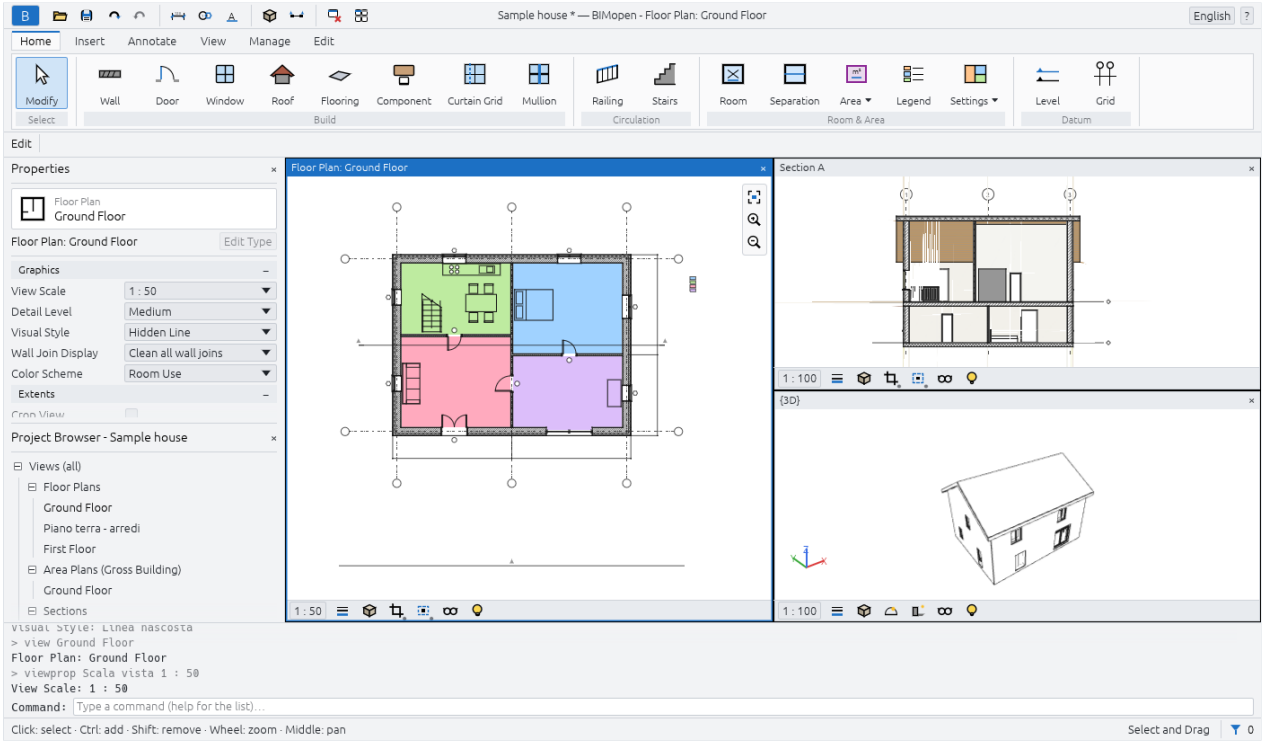
View control bar

At the bottom of every plan, section, elevation, callout and drafting view:

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Control	What it does
The scale, for example **1 : 100**	Opens the list of scales; under **Custom** type another one, as `1 : 75`, and press `Enter`
Detail level	**Coarse**, **Medium** or **Fine**
Crop View	Crops the view to its crop region, or stops cropping; a blue dot shows it is on
Show Crop Region	Shows or hides the crop region's frame; a blue dot shows it is on
Temporary Hide/Isolate	Hides or isolates elements or categories in this view until you reset it; framed while active

In a 3D view, the bar has the **Visual style** (**Wireframe**, **Hidden Line**, **Shaded**, **Shaded with Edges**, **Consistent Colors**) and **Temporary Hide/Isolate**. A sheet has no view control bar: its views have their own scale.



Navigation bar

On the right edge of the active view (the left edge in Arabic), three buttons: **Zoom to Fit** (the same as `Home`), **Zoom In** and **Zoom Out**.

Moving around in the views

In plans, sections, elevations and sheets	
Mouse wheel	Zooms in and out at the cursor
Drag with the middle button	Pans
Drag with the left button	A selection window, or moves the selected elements (Selecting and modifying)
`Home`	Fits the whole view in the window

In 3D views	
Drag with the right button, or `Shift` + middle button	Orbits around the model
Drag with the middle button	Pans
Drag with the left button	A selection window, or moves the selected elements
Mouse wheel	Zooms in and out
`Home`	Fits the whole model in the window

A small tripod in the lower corner of the 3D view shows the directions of the axes: X red, Y green, Z blue. A saved 3D view remembers where you left it.

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The context menu of a view

Right-click in a view while no tool is active. If the cursor is on an element that is not selected, the element is selected first. The menu has:

- **Cancel**: clears the selection;
- **Select All Instances ▸ Visible in View** or **▸ In Entire Project**: the elements of the same type; **Select Previous**: the selection made before;
- **Hide in view ▸ Elements** or **▸ Category**: hides the selected elements, or their whole categories, in this view;
- **Override graphics in view ▸ By category...**: opens **Visibility/Graphics** on the categories of the selection;
- **Visibility/Graphics...**.

While a tool is active, a right-click does what `Esc` does: it cancels the step in progress.

Command line

Under the drawing area, the command line shows the log of what has been done, the most recent at the bottom: the commands run, in grey after a `>`, their results, and errors in red. On its last row, the prompt says what the active tool expects, for example `WALL next point [Esc to finish]:`, or `Command:` when no tool is active.

You do not need to click it: whatever you type while no field is being edited goes to the command line. `Enter` runs the line; `Up` and `Down` bring back the lines typed before. The command line chapter describes the commands.

Status bar

On the left, the status bar shows:

- while a tool is active, what the tool expects (the same prompt as the command line);
- with no tool, the category and the type of the element under the cursor, as **Walls : Exterior wall - Clay block 300 + ETICS**;
- while you drag, the length of the move, as **Move: 1500**;
- otherwise a reminder of the mouse: **Click: select · Ctrl: add · Shift: remove · Wheel: zoom · Middle: pan** in plans, **Click: select · Right: orbit · Middle: pan · Wheel: zoom** in 3D.

On the right, the number of selected elements and a funnel: click the number to open **Filter**. Then **Select and Drag**, which lets you drag elements without selecting them first; in a plan, also the coordinates of the cursor in metres.

Selecting, in short

The selecting and modifying chapter describes selection in full. The essentials:

- click an element to select it; click an empty point to clear the selection;
- `Ctrl` + click adds an element to the selection, `Shift` + click takes it out; `Tab` highlights the next element under the cursor, or a chain of joined walls;
- drag from left to right to select what is entirely inside the rectangle, from right to left to select what it touches;
- drag a selected element to move it;
- `Ctrl+A` selects the elements of the open plan's level, or of the whole model in a 3D view; `Del` deletes the selection; `Esc` clears it.

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Interface styles

BIMopen has two interface styles. Both run the same commands, with the same names, keyboard shortcuts and results; only the look and the place of the tools change.

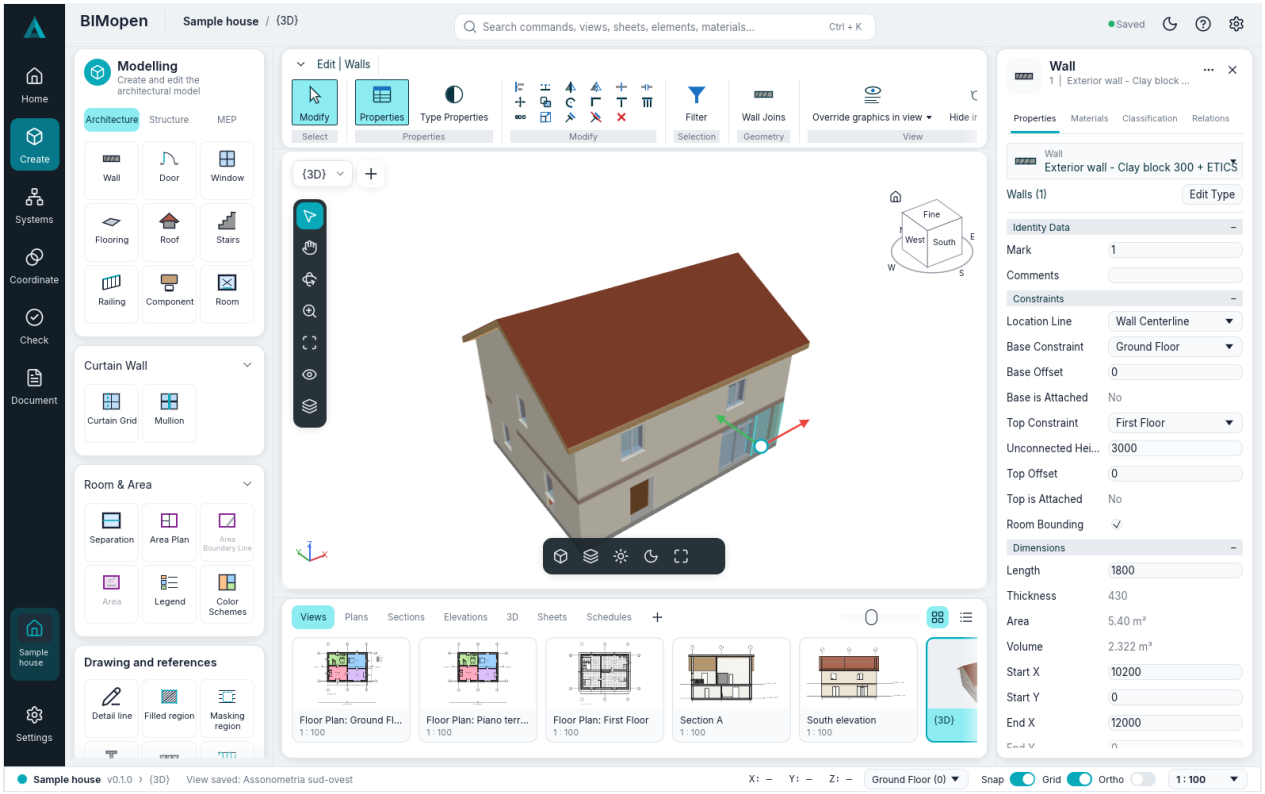
- The **Revit** style, described in The interface: the ribbon, the options bar, the **Properties** palette and the **Project Browser**. BIMopen starts in this style.
- The **BIMopen** style: a side rail, a command search, tool cards, tools floating over the view, an element panel with tabs and a strip of view thumbnails.

Choosing the style

1. Open the application menu and choose **Options** (in the **BIMopen** style, the gear at the right end of the top bar).
2. Under **User Interface**, set **Interface** to **Revit** or **BIMopen**.

The window changes at once. The choice is remembered, on the desktop and in the browser, and the next session starts in the same style. **Theme** (**Light** or **Dark**) applies to both styles.

The BIMopen style



Part	Where	What it holds
Rail	Left edge	**Home** (the project and its files), **Create** (the modelling tools), **Systems**, **Coordinate** (IFC export and views from other projects), **Check**, **Document** (views, graphics, sheets and schedules), the open project and **Settings** (the project settings and **Options**). A click on the selected entry folds the tool panel
Top bar	Top	The project and the active view, the command search, the save state, the light or dark theme, the help and **Options**
Tool panel	Left, beside the rail	The tools of the rail entry, as tiles. **Create** has the **Architecture** tab with the building tools, then **Curtain Wall**, **Room & Area**, **Drawing and references** and **Modify**
Context bar	Over the view, while a tool works or something is selected	What the options bar and the contextual **Modify** tab show in the **Revit** style: the options of the tool, the type properties, the modify tools, **Finish Edit Mode** and **Cancel Edit Mode** of a sketch. The chevron folds it to one row

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Part	Where	What it holds
View	Centre	The view selector and **+** for a new view; on the side, select, the **Pan**, **Orbit** (3D) and **Zoom** modes (with one on, the left button drags the view; `Esc` ends it), zoom to fit, hide and isolate, reveal hidden elements; in 3D views the ViewCube (a click on a face, an edge or a corner looks from there, a drag orbits, the house goes back to the starting view); on the selection, the move arrows (drag one to move along it, the centre to move freely in plan: the distance shows as you drag, the release moves as **Move** does); at the bottom, the visual style, the detail level, the sun path and the shadows in 3D, the crop region and full screen
Element panel	Right	The selected element: **Properties** (the same parameters as the **Properties** palette), **Materials** (the layers of its type with their colours and thicknesses, and a layered preview), **Classification** (category, type, IFC class) and **Relations** (level, host, hosted doors and windows, views and schedules). With nothing selected, the properties of the active view
View strip	Under the view	The views by kind (**Views**, **Plans**, **Sections**, **Elevations**, **3D**, **Sheets**, **Schedules**) as thumbnails or as a list; a click opens the view, **+** makes a new one
Status bar	Bottom	The project and the version, the active view, the prompt of the active tool, the cursor coordinates, the active level (its menu opens the plan of another level), the **Snap**, **Grid** and **Ortho** switches and the scale of the view

The **Structure** and **MEP** tabs of **Create**, and **Systems**, say that these disciplines are not in BIMopen yet.

Command search

Press `Ctrl+K`, or click the search box in the top bar, and type a few letters: the list shows the commands, views, sheets, schedules, elements and materials that match. Click a result, or choose it with the arrow keys and press `Enter`: a command starts, a view opens, an element is selected and shown, a material opens in **Materials**.

The search box is also the command line of the style. Typing in a view writes there, as the command line does in the **Revit** style, and `Enter` runs a keyboard shortcut (`WA`, `DR`, `ZF`…) or a command with its arguments (`wall 0,0 5,0`) as typed. The list of commands is in Command line and MCP.

Right-click menu

In plans, sections and 3D views the right button opens a dark menu: with a selection, the modify commands first (**Move**, **Copy**, **Rotate**, **Align**, **Offset** and the others), then the same items as the view's menu in the **Revit** style.

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Light and dark



In Arabic the whole window is mirrored, in both styles: the rail and the tool panel are on the right, the element panel on the left.

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Projects and files

This chapter describes how a project is created, opened, saved and exchanged with other programs, its settings and the options of BIMopen itself.

Creating a project

application menu ➤ New ➤ Project... opens **New project**:

- **Template file**: BIMopen's default template, or the one set in **Options ➤ File Locations**; a template file chosen with **Browse...**; or **None**, which starts from two levels and one type of each kind.
- **Create new**: **Project** or **Project Template**.

A project made from a template has everything the template had: types, settings, views, sheets, project information and print settings. Saving it asks for a name, so the template is not overwritten.

Templates

A template is a `.bimtpl` file. **application menu ➤ Save As ➤ Template...** saves the open project as a template; a project created as a **Project Template**, or a template opened, is saved as a template too.

Opening a project

`Ctrl+O`, **application menu ➤ Open...** or **Open** on the quick access toolbar opens a project. **application menu ➤ Recent Documents** lists the latest projects, the most recent first; a pin keeps a project in the list. Without a file, BIMopen starts on **Recent Files**, with the recent projects, **Open...**, **New** and the **Sample project** (unless **Enable Recent Files page at startup** is unticked in the options). Dropping a project file on the window opens it too.

A project already open in another BIMopen window opens read-only: **Save** asks for a new name. If BIMopen stopped without saving (a crash, a power cut), opening the project again brings the unsaved work back as unsaved changes.

Saving

`Ctrl+S`, or **Save** on the quick access toolbar, saves the project; until then the file stays as it was last saved, and the title bar shows an asterisk. **application menu ➤ Save As ➤ Project...** writes it to a new file and goes on there.

Save As ➤ Options... opens **File Save Options**: **Maximum backups** keeps that many earlier versions beside the file (`house.0001.bimopen`, `house.0002.bimopen` ...), deleting the oldest; **Compact file** rewrites the file without its obsolete parts at the next save.

When a changed project stays unsaved for the interval set in **Options ➤ General** (**Save reminder interval**, 30 minutes to start with), **Save Reminder** offers to save it, not to save it, or to change the interval.

Before **New**, **Open...**, a recent document, the sample project, or closing the window, a changed project asks **Save changes to ...?**: **Yes** saves it, **No** drops the changes, **Cancel** keeps it open.

In the browser, **Open...** uses the browser's file chooser, and **Save** downloads the file; backups, crash recovery and read-only opening need a file on disk and are desktop-only.

Project settings

Project information

Manage ➤ Settings ➤ Project information sets the project's name, number, client, address, issue date and status: the title blocks of every sheet show them.

Project units

Manage ➤ Settings ➤ Project units lists the quantities (length, area, volume, angle, slope and the others) with a sample of each, and the **Decimal symbol/digit grouping**. **Format...** of a quantity sets its unit, its **Rounding** (a number of decimals, or **Custom** with an **Increment factor**, such as 5 mm), its **Unit symbol**, **Suppress trailing zeros**, the plus sign for positive values and digit grouping.

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Sun Settings

Manage ➤ Additional settings ➤ Sun Settings opens the sun settings of the active view, the same as the sun button of the view control bar (see Views and graphics).

Options

application menu ➤ Options has four tabs; the choices are kept between sessions.

Tab	What it sets
General	The save reminder interval
User Interface	The theme (**Light** or **Dark**), the language, the interface style and size; **Enable Recent Files page at startup**; the ribbon tab after a selection ends or a tool closes (**Stay on the Modify tab** or **Return to the previous tab**) and **Display the contextual tab on selection**; **Tooltip Assistance** (**None**, **Minimal**, **Normal**, **Extra High**)
Graphics	**Invert background color**, **Selection color**, **Highlight color**, **Use anti-aliasing for 3D views**, **Temporary Dimension Text Appearance** (size and background)
File Locations	**Default template file path** (the template of **New**) and **Default path for user files** (where the file dialogs open)

Transferring project standards

Manage ➤ Settings ➤ Transfer Project Standards copies settings from another project into this one. In **Select Items To Copy**, choose the project with **Browse...** (**Copy from:**), then tick what to copy: the types of walls, floors, roofs, doors and windows, stairs, railings, curtain panels and mullions, line styles, filled region types, materials, fill and line patterns, line weights, object styles, view templates, filters, viewport types, title blocks, the project units, the print settings and the project information (**Check all**, **None**).

What is copied brings along what it uses: a wall type its materials, a material its patterns, a view template its filters. When names are already in the project, **Duplicate Types** asks whether to **Overwrite** them or to transfer the **New Only**. The whole transfer is one step of undo.

Exchanging files

Exporting to IFC

application menu ➤ Export ➤ IFC... writes the model in IFC4: walls with their axis and body, openings, doors, windows, floors, roofs, stairs, railings, curtain walls, furniture and rooms as spaces, on their storeys.

Export ➤ Options ➤ IFC Options... opens **IFC Export Classes**: the IFC class of each category; **Not Exported** leaves a category out, and **Default** goes back to the standard classes. The classes are kept with the project.

Opening IFC files

application menu ➤ Open ➤ IFC... makes a new project from an IFC2x3 or IFC4 file, in metres or millimetres: storeys become levels, walls are rebuilt from their axis (or from the long side of their body), slabs become floors, doors and windows go in the walls their openings cut, and spaces become rooms. The messages count what was not read.

Open ➤ IFC Options... opens **Import IFC Options**: what each IFC class becomes (walls, floors, doors, windows, rooms or **Not Imported**), and **Default**. The choices are kept between sessions.

Revit projects

Opening a `.rvt` file makes a new project from what can be read of it: levels, wall types and walls, doors and windows, floors. The messages say what was approximated.

Other exports

Printing to PDF and exporting images are described in Sheets, schedules and printing; schedules export as delimited text from the same chapter. `bimopen-cli convert` exports from the command line (see Command line and MCP).

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Selecting and modifying

Before most changes you select what to change. This chapter describes how elements are highlighted and selected, how a selection is refined, how selected elements are dragged, and the tools of the **Modify** panel. Everything here works the same in the desktop app and in the browser.

Highlighting and selecting

Move the cursor over an element: its lines are drawn wider, the status bar at the bottom of the window names it (category and type, as **Walls : Exterior wall…**), and after a moment the same words appear under the cursor. Click to select the highlighted element. A selected element is drawn in the selection colour in every view where it shows, and the count at the right end of the status bar says how many elements are selected.

A right click on an element selects it and opens the context menu. `Esc`, or a click on an empty spot, clears the selection.

To…	Do this
add an element to the selection	`Ctrl` + click
take an element out of the selection	`Shift` + click
select what is wholly inside a window	drag from left to right
select what a window touches	drag from right to left (the window is dashed)
add, or take away, what a window catches	drag with `Ctrl`, or with `Shift`
select again what was selected before	`Ctrl+Left`, or right click ▸ **Select Previous**

Windows work in plans, sections, sheets and 3D views. In a 3D view the left button selects; the right button orbits and the middle button pans (see The interface).

Elements close together: TAB

When elements lie close together or one over the other, the one highlighted may not be the one you want. Keep the cursor still and press `Tab`: the next element under the cursor is highlighted and the status bar names it. `Shift+Tab` goes back. Click to select the highlighted element. In a 3D view `Tab` goes from the nearest element to the ones behind it; on a sheet, through views placed one over the other.

Chains of walls and lines

Walls and lines joined end to end form a chain. With the cursor on one of them, `Tab` highlights the whole chain (the status bar says **Chain of n joined elements**); a click selects it. A chain can mix walls with room separation lines and area boundaries; detail lines chain with the detail lines of their view. Where three or more meet, the chain goes on along the one that makes the smallest angle with the last; a wall that stops against another one between its ends takes the chain on along that wall.

Part of a chain. Select the first element of the part, move the cursor over the last one and press `Tab`: the elements between them are highlighted. `Tab` again highlights the whole chain, a third time the last element alone. Click to select what is highlighted. On a closed chain the part goes round by the side where the cursor is: near the end of the last element that one way round reaches first.

Elements joined at a point. Select an element and keep the cursor on it, near an end where others are joined. `Tab` highlights it with the nearest one joined there; `Tab` again, every element joined there. Click to select them.

A selected chain. Where two selected walls or lines meet, a round control appears. Drag it to move the joint: the selected ends there move together and stay joined; elements not selected are left where they are. Drag the chain with `Shift` to move it whole, horizontally or vertically; drag it with `Ctrl` to place a copy.

Filtering a selection

Click the count in the status bar, or **Filter** on the contextual tab, to open **Filter**. It lists the categories in the selection, how many elements each has, and the total. Untick a category to leave its elements out: the selection and the count in the status bar follow at once. **Check all** and **Check none** tick or untick every category. **OK** keeps the selection, **Cancel** brings back the one you started with.

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Select All Instances

Right-click an element ▸ **Select All Instances**, then **Visible in View** (the elements of the same type shown in the active view) or **In Entire Project**. Typing `SA` and `Enter` does the same as **Visible in View**. The element must have a type: rooms, for example, have none.

Dragging elements

Drag a selected element to move it; the whole selection moves together, and one drag is undone by one `Ctrl+Z`. A temporary dimension shows the move, and the status bar its length (**Move: 1500**). With **Select and Drag** turned on in the status bar, an element can be dragged without selecting it first; with it off, a drag that starts on an element not selected draws a window.

- A wall joined at its ends to walls that are not selected moves square to itself only, and the joined walls stretch to stay joined. Walls that stop against it follow too. Hold `Shift` to move it freely; the joined walls still follow.
- Any other element moves freely; hold `Shift` to keep the move horizontal or vertical.
- Doors and windows move with their wall and keep their place along it. Dragged on their own, they slide along the wall; dropped on another wall, they move into it.
- Hold `Ctrl` when you start dragging to place a copy instead.

Elements are dragged in plans, sections and elevations (along the view), on sheets (views), and in 3D views, where they move on the horizontal plane where you grabbed them. The arrow keys move the selection a small step, rounded to a tidy value at the zoom of the view; with `Shift`, ten steps.

The Modify tools

The **Modify** panel of the contextual tab has three rows: **Align**, **Offset**, **Mirror - Pick Axis**, **Mirror - Draw Axis**, **Split Element**, **Split with Gap**; **Move**, **Copy**, **Rotate**, **Trim/Extend to Corner**, **Trim/Extend Single Element**, **Trim/Extend Multiple Elements**; **Array**, **Scale**, **Pin**, **Unpin**, **Delete**. The status bar says what each tool expects next, and the options bar shows its options. `Esc` cancels the step in progress; pressed again, it ends the tool.

Move, **Copy**, **Rotate**, the two **Mirror** tools, **Array** and **Scale** work on the selection. Started with nothing selected, they let you select first (clicks, `Ctrl`, windows, `Tab`), then go on when you press `Enter` or **End** on the options bar.

Move, **Copy** and **Rotate** also work in 3D views: their points are taken on the plane of the level clicked.

Before each click the tool shows what the click would do: the selection drawn where it would go (moved, copied, turned, mirrored about the axis under the cursor, offset to the cursor's side, aligned to the reference), following the cursor, with the distance or the angle beside it.

Where a tool asks for a second point, you can type a distance (or an angle) instead and press `Enter`: it shows next to the cursor while you type, and is measured towards the cursor.

Move

Click a base point, then the destination. The tool ends and the elements stay selected. Options:

- **Constrain**: the move is along or square to the selected wall (horizontal or vertical for other elements);
- **Disjoin**: walls joined to the moved ones do not follow, and a door or window can be moved onto another wall;
- **Copy**: copies are placed instead; with **Multiple**, one at each click until `Esc`.

Copy

As **Move**, but a copy is placed. With **Multiple**, a copy at each click until `Esc`; **Constrain** as for Move.

Rotate

The centre of rotation shows at the middle of the selection; drag it to put it elsewhere. Click the first ray, then the second: the selection turns by the angle between them, shown by a temporary angular dimension. Instead of the second ray, type the angle and press `Enter`, or type it in **Angle** on the options bar and press `Enter`. **Copy** turns a copy; without **Disjoin**, walls joined to the turned ones follow.

Mirror

Mirror - Pick Axis: click a wall, a grid or a line as the axis. **Mirror - Draw Axis**: click two points. **Copy** is ticked: a mirrored copy is placed; untick it to mirror the elements themselves.

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Array

Linear: click two points. **Number** is how many elements in all. With **Move To: 2°** the two points give the spacing; with **Last**, the last element goes to the second point and the others are spread evenly. **Constrain** keeps the direction along or square to the selection.

Radial: drag the centre where the copies turn about, click the first ray, then the second (or type the angle and press `Enter`, also in **Angle**). With **2°** the angle is between neighbours, with **Last** it is the whole span.

Offset

Moves a wall or a line square to itself, or places a copy (**Copy** is ticked).

- **Numerical**: set **Offset**, then click the element on the side it should go to. Press `Tab` first to offset the whole chain (of the same category) as one: its corners are kept.
- **Graphical**: click the element (`Tab` for the chain), then two points: the distance between them, square to the element, is the offset. You can type it instead. `Ctrl` copies.

Align

Click the reference, then the element to align: the face of the element nearest to your click goes onto the face of the reference nearest to its click. **Prefer** chooses **Wall faces** or **Wall centerlines**. After aligning, a padlock shows on the aligned face: click it to keep the two aligned, so that moving the reference moves the other one too. Without **Multiple Alignment** the next click picks a new reference; with it (or holding `Ctrl`) you can align several elements to the same one. `Esc` once starts a new alignment, twice ends the tool.

Trim/Extend

Walls and lines are trimmed or extended; click each one on the part to keep.

- **Trim/Extend to Corner**: two elements, which then meet at a corner;
- **Trim/Extend Single Element**: the boundary, then the element;
- **Trim/Extend Multiple Elements**: the boundary, then each element in turn.

Split Element and Split with Gap

Split Element: click a wall or a line where it should become two. With **Delete Inner Segment**, click two points: the part between them is removed, with the doors and windows in it. **Split with Gap**: set **Joint Gap**, then click: the two parts are that far apart.

Scale

Walls and lines (and the position of dimensions) can be scaled; with anything else selected, **Scale** is not available. **Graphical**: click the origin, the end of a first vector, the end of a second one: the elements are scaled by the ratio of the two lengths (you can type the second one). **Numerical**: set **Scale Factor**, then click the origin. Doors and windows keep their distance from the middle of their wall.

Pin and Unpin

Pin keeps the selected elements where they are: they cannot be dragged, moved by a tool or deleted, and a message says so. A pinned element shows a pushpin when selected; click the pushpin, or use **Unpin**, to free it.

Delete, undo and redo

Delete (or the `Del` key) removes the selection and what it hosts; pinned elements stay. `Ctrl+Z` undoes the last change and `Ctrl+Y` redoes it: each tool, drag or nudge is one step.

Typed shortcuts

Type the letters and press `Enter`: `MV` **Move**, `CO` **Copy**, `RO` **Rotate**, `MM` **Mirror - Pick Axis**, `DM` **Mirror - Draw Axis**, `AR` **Array**, `OF` **Offset**, `AL` **Align**, `TR` **Trim/Extend to Corner**, `SL` **Split Element**, `SG` **Split with Gap**, `RE` **Scale**. `PN` pins and `UP` unpins the selection, `SA` selects all its instances visible in the view. Keyboard shortcuts lists them all.

Not yet available

- `Tab` to reach a part of an element: a curtain panel or mullion, a part of a stacked wall;

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- **Select All Instances** from a type in the Project Browser;
- **Group and Associate** of **Array**;
- splitting walls along a horizontal line in elevations and 3D views;
- cut, copy and paste through the clipboard, **Paste Aligned**, **Create Similar**.

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Walls, doors and windows

This chapter describes how walls are drawn, how they join and attach to roofs and floors, how their types and layers are set up, and how doors and windows are placed in them, flipped, moved and drawn at each detail level.

Drawing walls

Home ▸ Build ▸ Wall (or type `WA`) starts the wall tool, in a plan or in the 3D view. Pick the wall type in the type selector at the top of the **Properties** palette; **Type Properties** changes the type, and with it every wall of that type. The contextual tab **Edit | Place Wall** shows the **Draw** panel, and the options bar shows:

Option	What it does
Height or **Depth**	The wall rises from the level (**Height**) or goes down from it (**Depth**)
A level, or **Unconnected** with a value	The wall reaches that level, or is that high (or deep)
Level	In a 3D view only: the level the walls stand on; takes the level of the surface of the first click
Location Line	The plane of the wall that runs along the clicks: **Wall Centerline** (the default), the core centre line, or one of the finish and core faces, exterior or interior
Chain	On, each click ends a wall and starts the next one; off, each two clicks make a wall on its own
Offset	The location line runs this far from the clicks, towards the exterior
Radius	Not available: it needs curved walls, and is shown disabled

While drawing:

- the wall's exterior is on the left of the drawing direction: drawn from left to right, the exterior face is at the top. The preview shows the exterior face thicker;
- the **space bar** puts the exterior of the next wall on the other side;
- after the first point, type a length and press Enter: the wall ends that far, in the direction of the cursor;
- **Esc** ends the chain; **Esc** again, or **Modify**, ends the tool.

The **Draw** panel picks the shape:

Shape	How
Line	Click the start and the end of each wall
Rectangle	Click two opposite corners: four joined walls, with the exterior outside
Inscribed Polygon	Set **Sides** in the options bar, click the centre and a corner: the corners are on the circle
Circumscribed Polygon	The same, but the sides touch the circle
Pick Lines	Click a line of the plan (a line or an edge of an element): a wall along it. Press **TAB** over a line to take the whole chain of lines joined to it, then click

The location line and flipping

Select a wall: blue dots mark the ends of its location line, and two arrows stand on its exterior side. Clicking the arrows turns the wall over about its location line: the first and the last layers swap, and the doors and windows keep their orientation. Changing **Location Line** of a placed wall does not move it; the next flip turns it about the new plane. Changing the type of a wall, or its layers, keeps its location line where it was.

Attaching walls to roofs and floors

A wall can follow a roof or a floor instead of a fixed height.

1. Select the walls.
2. **Edit | Walls ▸ Modify Wall ▸ Attach Top/Base**.
3. In the options bar, **Attach Wall: Top** or **Base**.

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4. Click the roof or floor, in a plan, a section or the 3D view.

With **Top**, the walls rise or drop to the underside of the roof (following its slopes: the gable walls go up to the ridge) or of the floor above. With **Base**, they stand on the top face of the floor below. From then on they follow it: a steeper roof, a roof raised by its base offset, a moved floor carry the walls with them.

To detach them: select the walls, **Edit | Walls ▸ Modify Wall ▸ Detach Top/Base**, then click the element to detach them from, or press **Detach All** in the options bar. The walls keep the height they have at that moment, and can be attached again at any time. When a roof or floor with walls attached to it is deleted, the walls keep their height too.

The properties **Top is Attached** and **Base is Attached** show the state (read-only); while the top is attached, **Unconnected Height** is read-only.

Editing a wall's profile

A wall need not be a rectangle: its outline can be sketched in an elevation or a section parallel to it, with holes, as for a gable or a stepped wall.

1. Select the wall and click **Mode ▸ Edit Profile** in its contextual tab. From a plan or a view that is not parallel to the wall, **Go To View** lists the sections and elevations parallel to it: choose one and click **Open View**.
2. Sketch mode opens with the wall's outline in magenta. Change it with **Line** and **Rectangle** (see sketch mode): pick a line and press `Del`, draw new ones; a loop inside is a hole.
3. Click **Finish Edit Mode** (or **Cancel Edit Mode** to leave the wall as it was).

The wall takes that outline in 3D, in sections and in plan, where it is cut only where the outline reaches the cut plane; its doors and windows still cut it. A top attached to a roof or a floor still clips it. A curtain wall keeps the panels and mullions inside its new outline. **Mode ▸ Reset Profile** makes it a rectangle again; `Ctrl+Z` undoes either.

Wall joins

Walls whose ends meet join by themselves, and so do a wall ending on the side of another and two walls crossing each other. At **Medium** and **Fine** detail each layer is resolved against the layers of the other wall:

- at a corner (an L), each layer meets the same layer of the other wall: the finishes wrap round the corner and the cores meet;
- at a T, the core of the wall that ends runs through the finishes of the other wall up to its core; its own finishes stop at the face, which is open there;
- where two walls cross (an X), a core runs through the finishes of the other wall;
- pieces of the same material merge with no line between them; a thin line separates two different materials; the free outline is drawn thick.

At **Coarse** detail joined walls are one fill, with no line between them. Sections and the 3D view use the same pieces, so nothing overlaps.

The Wall Joins tool

Edit ▸ Geometry ▸ Wall Joins, then click the grey square that appears on a corner. The options bar offers:

- **Configuration: Butt** (one wall runs through, the other stops against it), **Miter** (both end on the bisector) or **Square off** (the wall that stops ends square); **Previous** and **Next** change which wall runs through;
- **Display: Clean Join**, **Don't Clean Join** (the walls butt, with a thick line between them) or **Use View Setting**.

Each change can be undone. **Esc** ends the tool.

The plan's property **Wall Join Display** (in **Graphics**) is the view setting: **Clean all wall joins**, or **Clean same wall type** to keep a thick line where walls of two types meet, unless their corner is set to **Clean Join**.

Disallowing a join

To keep an end of a wall from joining (an expansion gap, say), select the wall, right-click the blue dot of that end and choose **Disallow Join**: both walls then end square, apart. A small mark beside the end shows it; click it, or right-click the dot and choose **Allow Join**, to join it again.

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Wall types and layers

Type Properties of a wall shows, under **Construction**, **Structure** with its **Edit…** button, **Wrapping at Inserts**, **Wrapping at Ends**, **Width** (the sum of the layers, read-only) and **Function** (**Interior**, **Exterior**, **Foundation**, **Retaining**, **Soffit**, **Core-shaft**); under **Graphics**, **Coarse Scale Fill Pattern** and **Coarse Scale Fill Color**, how cut walls of the type are filled at **Coarse** detail. **Duplicate…** makes a new type; its name does not follow its layers.

Structure ▸ Edit… opens **Edit assembly**: the layers from the exterior side to the interior side, each with its function, material and thickness, between the two **Core Boundary** rows. **Insert**, **Delete**, **Up** and **Down** change the list. A membrane layer has no thickness, and every other layer is at least 4 mm thick: other values are refused, and the dialog stays open.

The **Wraps** column ticks the layers that may wrap. Below the table:

- **Wrapping at Inserts** (**Do not wrap**, **Exterior**, **Interior**, **Both**): the ticked layers outside the core on that side turn into the jambs of doors and windows; the layers behind them are pulled back;
- **Wrapping at Ends** (**Do not wrap**, **Exterior**, **Interior**): the same at the free ends of the walls.

Wrapping is drawn in plan only. A door or window type overrides the wall's wrapping with its **Wall Closure**.

Wall properties

Under **Constraints**: **Location Line**, **Base Constraint**, **Base Offset**, **Base is Attached**, **Top Constraint** (a level, or **Unconnected**), **Unconnected Height**, **Top Offset** (with a level), **Top is Attached** and **Room Bounding** (untick it and the rooms around the wall ignore it). Under **Dimensions**: **Length**, **Area**, **Volume**. Under **Identity Data**: **Mark** and **Comments**.

Placing doors and windows

Home ▸ Build ▸ Door (`DR`) or **Window** (`WN`), in a plan, a section, an elevation or the 3D view. Pick the type, then move over a wall: the opening follows the cursor along it, and temporary dimensions measure from its centre line to the centre lines of the nearest walls across the host on each side. A door swings to the side of the wall the cursor is on; the **space bar** puts its hinge on the other jamb. Click to place it: the wall is cut in every view. A window takes its type's **Default Sill Height**.

Doors and windows get a **Mark** that counts up by category (1, 2, 3…), from the highest.

Tags

Edit | Place Door ▸ Tag ▸ Tag on Placement (or the same for windows) tags each opening as it is placed. The options bar then offers **Horizontal** or **Vertical**, and **Leader** with its length. A door's tag shows its **Mark**; a window's tag shows its type's **Type Mark**. **Annotate ▸ Tag All** tags the openings not tagged yet.

Flipping a door or window

Select a door or window in a plan: arrows across the wall, on the side it opens to, turn its swing over; arrows beside it, along the wall, put its hinge on the other jamb. The context menu does the same: **Flip Hand** (the hinge) and **Flip Facing** (the swing).

Moving a door or window to another wall

Select it, **Edit | Doors ▸ Host ▸ Pick New Host** (or **Edit | Windows**), then click another wall: the opening moves there, where you clicked, with its type and sill. It stays selected.

Door and window properties

Instance: **Level**, **Sill Height**, **Width** and **Height** (of the type), **Head Height**, **Comments**, **Mark**. Changing **Sill Height** or **Head Height** moves the opening up or down; its size stays.

Type: **Wall Closure** (**By host**, or a wrapping of its own), **Function** (**Interior** or **Exterior**), **Door Material** (**Glass Material** for windows) and **Frame Material**, **Trim Width**, **Thickness** (of a door's leaf, or the depth of a window's frame), **Default Sill Height** and **Window Inset** (windows: how far the frame sits from the exterior face), **Trim Projection Ext** and **Trim Projection Int** (doors), **Leaves** and **Type Mark**. A door cannot become a window by changing its type.

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How walls, doors and windows are drawn

The **Detail Level** of the plan decides:

	Coarse	Medium	Fine
Walls	One fill (or the type's coarse pattern), joined walls merged	Each layer with its material's cut pattern	As **Medium**
Windows	The frame as one outline, the glass along it, the wall below seen as lines	The frame cut at each jamb and at the mullion of a two-leaf window, at its inset; one line of glass; the exterior sill and the interior sill board	As **Medium**, with double glass
Doors	The leaf as a line and its swing	The frame at each jamb, the leaf with its thickness, its swing	As **Medium**, with the trims out of the faces

In every case the layers end at the jambs of the opening, closed by the cut line, or wrap into them as the types ask. In sections and in 3D, doors and windows show their frame, leaves, glass and sills, in the type's materials.

Curtain walls

A curtain wall is a wall of a curtain wall type, drawn with the **Wall** tool: pick **Curtain Wall** (one glass panel the length of the wall), **Exterior Glazing** (grid lines by the type) or **Storefront** (grid lines and mullions) in the type selector, then draw as for any wall, in plan or in 3D, with **Chain** and the **Draw** shapes. A basic wall changes into a curtain wall by picking a curtain wall type in the type selector; the doors and windows it hosts are deleted, because a curtain wall does not host them, and a message says so (undo brings them back).

In plan each glass panel is drawn with its thickness and the mullions are cut. A type with **Automatically Embed** ticked (the **Storefront**) drawn along a wall cuts its own hole in it, in plan, sections, 3D and IFC.

- The type's **Vertical Layout** and horizontal layout (**Fixed distance**, **Fixed number**, **Maximum spacing**) with their spacing, and the instance's **Number of Vertical Grids** and **Vertical Justification**, place the grid lines by themselves.
- **Home ▸ Build ▸ Curtain Grid**: click near the top or bottom edge for a vertical line, near a side for a horizontal one, in an elevation, a section or a plan; it snaps to the middle and the thirds of the panel.
- **Home ▸ Build ▸ Mullion**: **Grid Line**, **Grid Line Segment** or **All Grid Lines**, with the mullion type picked in the type selector.
- Select the curtain wall, then **Panel** in its contextual tab: pick a panel type (a **Curtain Wall Door**, a glazed or solid panel, or none) and click the panel to change.

Panels and mullions have their own schedules, and the IFC export writes the curtain wall with its plates and members.

At the command line

The same operations, typed:

```
attach                    attach the selected walls to the roof over them
attach 412                attach their top to element 412 (a roof or a floor)
attach base 398           attach their base to the floor 398
detach all                detach them from everything
walljoin 0,0 {"kind":"Giunto d'angolo","cleanup":"Non calcolare unioni"}
walljoin 57 1 disallow    wall 57 does not join at its end
rehost 120 12,4           move door or window 120 into the wall at 12,4
door {"point":[3,0],"tag":{"vertical":true,"leader":true,"length":1}}
```

Not available yet

Curved walls (**Arc**, **Circle**, **Radius**), **Pick Faces**, structural walls, stacked walls, wall sweeps and reveals, vertically compound layers (regions), **Join Geometry**, phases, and skylights in roofs.

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Floors, roofs, stairs and components

Floors, roofs, stairs and railings are drawn in **sketch mode**: their lines are sketched first, and the element is made only when the sketch is finished. Components (furniture and plumbing fixtures) are placed with a click. Curtain walls are described in Walls, doors and windows.

Sketch mode

Home ▸ Build ▸ Flooring, **Roof**, **Stairs** and **Railing** open sketch mode. The contextual tab is named after what is sketched (**Edit | Create Floor Boundary**, **Create Roof Footprint**, **Create Stairs Sketch**, **Create Railing Path**) and has:

- the **Mode** panel: **Finish Edit Mode** makes the element; **Cancel Edit Mode** drops the sketch and leaves the model as it was;
- the **Draw** panel, with the drawing tools of the element;
- for stairs and railings, the **Tools** panel.

Nothing is made while sketching: the lines are magenta, and the model changes only with **Finish Edit Mode**. The whole element is then one step of the undo history: one `Ctrl+Z` takes it away.

Drawing lines

Tool	How it draws
Line	Click point after point: each click ends a line and starts the next. The length and angle of the line under the cursor are shown beside it; `Shift` keeps it horizontal or vertical. With **Chain** off on the options bar, each line is drawn on its own. Clicking the start of the chain again closes the loop
Rectangle	Two opposite corners: four lines
Pick Walls	Click a wall: its line is added to the sketch (see below). Press `Tab` over a wall, then click, to pick the whole chain of walls joined end to end
Slope Arrow	Click the tail, then the head of the arrow (floors and roofs)

Offset on the options bar moves the drawn lines (and the lines of picked walls) by that distance.

Floors and roofs need closed loops. A loop drawn inside the outer one is an **opening**: the floor or the roof has a hole there. When **Finish Edit Mode** finds lines that do not close or that cross, a message says so and the sketch stays open to be fixed (**Continue**).

Picking and changing sketch lines

`Esc` ends the chain being drawn; a second `Esc` puts the drawing tool down (so does **Modify**), and the sketch lines can be clicked. The picked line is blue and its properties are in the **Properties** palette: **Defines Slope** and **Slope**, for a roof line picked from a wall its **Overhang**, and its **Length**. `Del` deletes the picked line. `Ctrl+Z` while sketching takes back the last change to the sketch, not to the model.

Editing the sketch of an element

Select a floor, a roof, a stair or a railing: the **Mode** panel of its contextual tab has **Edit Boundary** (floors), **Edit Footprint** (roofs), **Edit Sketch** (stairs) or **Edit Path** (railings). Sketch mode opens with the element's lines, openings, slopes and arrow; **Finish Edit Mode** changes the same element, **Cancel Edit Mode** leaves it unchanged.

Floors

1. Click **Home ▸ Build ▸ Flooring**. Sketch mode starts with **Pick Walls**.
2. Click the walls around the floor, or press `Tab` over one of them and click to pick them all. Each line goes on the **interior face** of its wall; the lines of walls that meet are trimmed or extended to meet at the corner.
3. Or draw the boundary with **Line** or **Rectangle**; draw a loop inside it for an opening.
4. Click **Finish Edit Mode**.

On the options bar, **Extend into wall (to core)** puts picked lines into the wall up to the face of its core, and **Offset** moves them (a negative offset moves them away from the walls). The type of the new floor is the one in the type selector at the top of **Properties**.

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Sloped floors

A floor slopes in one direction, set in one of two ways while sketching:

- a **Slope Arrow**: its properties are **Specify** (**Height at Tail**, from the heights of its two ends, or **Slope**), **Height Offset at Tail**, **Height Offset at Head** and **Slope**. The heights are measured from the top of the floor;
- one boundary line with **Defines Slope** ticked and its **Slope** in degrees: the floor rises from that line, inwards.

The floor is sloped in 3D and in sections. Its **Slope Angle** in **Properties** changes the slope afterwards.

Floors over walls

When a floor crosses walls (an upper floor resting on the walls below, for instance), its slab is cut out of them: in 3D and in sections the wall stops under the floor and goes on above it, and walls go on through the floor's openings.

Floor properties

Property	What it is
Level, **Height Offset From Level**	The level and the height of the top face from it
Slope Angle	The slope of a sloped floor, in degrees
Thickness	From the type's layers (read-only)
Perimeter, **Area**, **Volume**	Without the openings (read-only)
Comments, **Mark**	Free text

Type Properties has the floor's **Structure** (its layers) and its default thickness.

Roofs

1. Click **Home ▸ Build ▸ Roof**. Sketch mode starts with **Pick Walls**; the options bar has **Defines Slope**, **Overhang** and **Extend into wall (to core)**.
2. Pick the walls (Tab for the whole chain). Each line goes on the **exterior face** of its wall, moved out by the overhang (from the face of the core with **Extend into wall (to core)**).
3. Or draw the footprint with **Line** or **Rectangle**; a loop inside is an opening.
4. Click **Finish Edit Mode**.

Every line with **Defines Slope** rises inwards at its **Slope** (30° by default); a small triangle with the slope is drawn beside it. The shape comes from those lines:

- all the lines define the slope: a **hip** roof;
- two opposite lines do not: a **gable** roof, the walls under the gables rise to the ridge when attached;
- no line defines the slope: a **flat** roof, or a roof sloping along a **Slope Arrow** (then no line may define a slope).

To change one line, press Esc twice, click the line and change **Defines Roof Slope**, **Slope** or (lines picked from walls) **Overhang** in **Properties**.

Select walls, click **Modify Wall ▸ Attach Top/Base**, then the roof: they rise to its underside, gables included (Walls, doors and windows tells more).

Roof properties

Property	What it is
Base Level, **Base Offset From Level**	Where the eaves are: by default on top of the walls of the level
Slope	The slope of every line that defines one (or of the arrow)
Thickness, **Maximum Ridge Height**, **Area**, **Volume**	Read-only
Comments, **Mark**	Free text

In plan a roof shows its outline, ridges and hips; in 3D its slopes, overhangs and layers.

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Stairs

1. Click **Home ▸ Circulation ▸ Stairs**. Sketch mode starts with **Run**.
2. Click where the first riser is, then where the run ends: the run snaps to whole treads, and the status bar counts the risers made and left (for example `9 risers created, 8 remaining`).
3. To turn, click again away from the end of the first run and draw the next one: a landing joins them.
4. When every riser is placed, click **Finish Edit Mode**.

The **Width** on the options bar is that of the new stair (by default the type's). **Tools ▸ Railing Type** chooses the railings of the new stair: a railing type, put on both sides, or **None**.

The number of risers comes from the height between **Base Level** and **Top Level** (with their offsets) and the type's **Maximum Riser Height**; changing a level or an offset in **Properties** changes the risers. **Edit Sketch** reopens the runs: delete a run (click it, `Del`) and draw it again; the railings of the stair follow.

In plan the stair shows its treads up to the cut line, the break line, the arrow and the **UP**/**DN** text; in 3D its treads and risers, or a monolithic slab, its landings and railings.

How a stair is built

Type Properties of the stair decide its construction:

- **Monolithic Stairs** ticked: each run is a concrete slab cut to the steps; its underside runs parallel to the slope, **Structural Depth** below the inner corners of the steps, and the landings are as thick;
- otherwise treads (**Tread Thickness**) with risers (**Riser Type Straight**, **Riser Thickness**) or open (**None**), on stringers: **Right Stringer** and **Left Stringer Closed** (a board the treads are housed in), **Open** (a board cut to the steps, the treads on top) or **None**, and **Middle Stringers** under the treads, with their **Stringer Thickness** and **Stringer Height**.

A section across the stair shows it cut with its slab. **Volume** in **Properties** and in the schedule of stairs is the volume of its solids.

Railings

1. Click **Home ▸ Circulation ▸ Railing**.
2. Draw the path with **Line**: one chain of connected lines (a path in pieces is refused at **Finish Edit Mode**).
3. To put the railing on a stair, click **Tools ▸ Pick New Host** and then the stair: the path drawn on it climbs with the stair.
4. Click **Finish Edit Mode**.

Edit Path reopens the path of a railing. The railing's **Type Properties** has its **Railing Height** and **Baluster Spacing**: changing them changes every railing of that type.

Components

1. Click **Home ▸ Build ▸ Component**. The type selector lists the components loaded in the project; a preview follows the cursor, in plan and in the 3D view.
2. Press `Space` to turn the preview by 90°.
3. Click to place the component on the level of the plan.

Mode ▸ Load Family opens the library, by folder (**Furniture**, **Plumbing Fixtures**): choose a family and click **Open** to add its types to the project.

Select a component and click **Host ▸ Pick New Host**, then a floor: the component moves onto the floor and stays on its top (click an empty point to put it back on the level). Its properties are **Level**, **Host**, **Offset from Level**, **Rotation**, **Mark** and **Comments**; **Type Properties** has its width, depth, height and material.

Schedules and IFC

Floors, roofs, stairs, railings and furniture have their schedules (**View ▸ Create ▸ Schedules ▸ Schedule/Quantities**), one row per element. **Export ▸ Export IFC4...** writes floors as slabs (with their openings and slopes), roofs, stairs with their flights and landings, railings, furniture and plumbing fixtures.

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Not yet in BIMopen

Ceilings, ramps, roofs by extrusion, shafts and vertical openings, slab edges, fascias, gutters and soffits, stairs sketched by boundary and riser lines, spiral stairs, and arcs in sketches come after this chapter's realignment.

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Views and graphics

This chapter describes the views of the model, how each one is drawn, and how to change what a view shows and how: visual styles, scale and detail level, the view range of a plan, crop regions, hiding and isolating, **Visibility/Graphics**, filters and view templates. Line weights, line patterns and object styles are described in the same terms by the program's dialogs **Manage ▸ Settings**.

3D views

View ▸ Create ▸ 3D View ▸ Default 3D View opens the default 3D view, **{3D}**, framing the whole model; opened again, it shows the model as it was left. Drag to orbit (or **Shift** and the middle button), drag with the middle button to pan, and turn the wheel to zoom at the cursor; see The interface.

To keep a framing, **View ▸ Create ▸ 3D View ▸ Save View**: type a name and press Enter. The new view is listed under **3D Views** in the **Project Browser** and opens at once; it keeps the framing it is left with. Renaming **{3D}** in the **Project Browser** (right-click ▸ **Rename...**) does the same: **{3D}** becomes a named view, and the next default 3D view is a new **{3D}**.

A selected element is washed in blue and half see-through, its edges in blue: what is behind it stays visible.

Floors cut the walls they pass through: where a slab crosses a wall the wall stops under it and goes on above it, so the slab's edge and the wall's face are one surface.

Visual styles

The **Visual Style** button of the view control bar, at the bottom of every view window, offers:

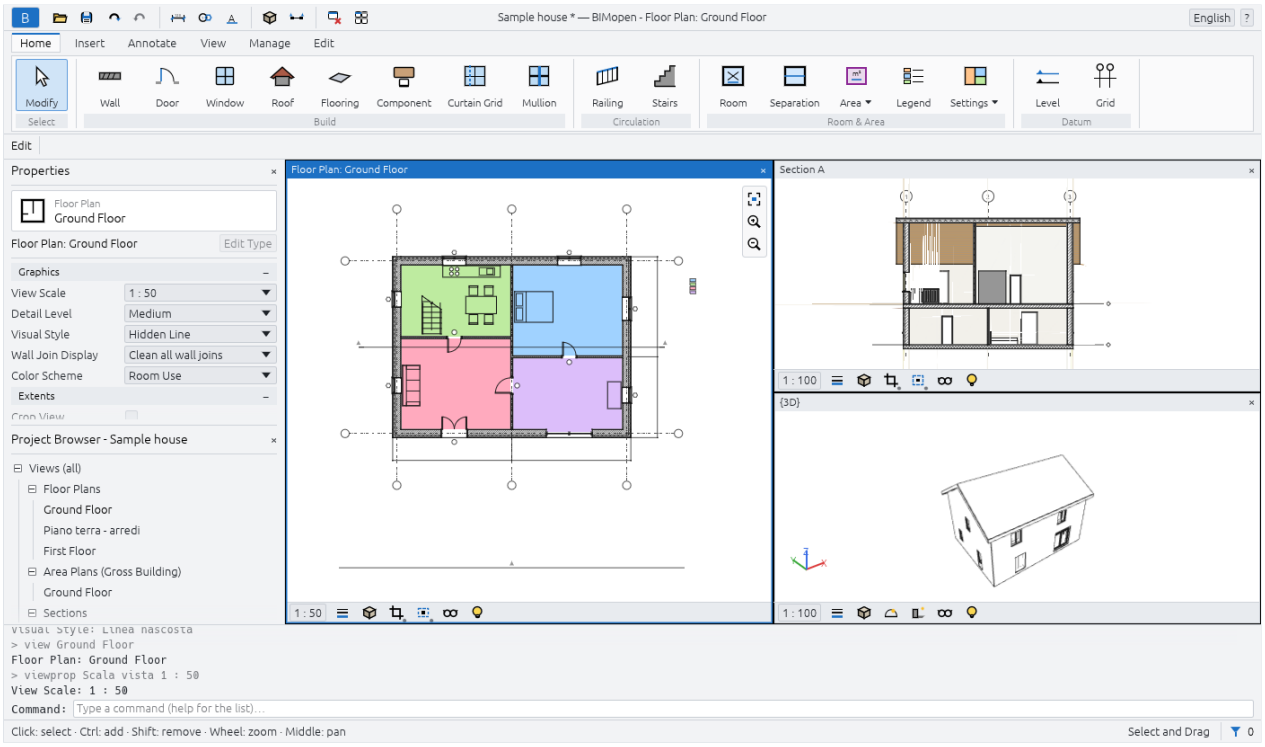
Style	What is drawn
Wireframe	Every edge, also those behind other faces; no faces
Hidden Line	Faces in the paper colour and the edges in front of them
Shaded	Faces lit, in the colour of their material
Shaded with Edges	As **Shaded**, with the edges in front
Consistent Colors	Faces in the colour of their material, the same whatever the light

The style belongs to the view and can be undone. The keyboard shortcuts `WF`, `HL` and `SD` choose **Wireframe**, **Hidden Line** and **Shaded**.

The edges are the real ones: where two faces meet at an angle, and the outline of each face and each opening. A wall with a window shows its own outline and the window's, and no line where the pieces of the wall meet.

Plans, sections and elevations have a visual style too. A plan is drawn in **Hidden Line** until another style is chosen; in **Shaded** its floors, seen from above, take the colour of their material, and the faces of sections and elevations take their materials' colours.

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Sun and shadows

In a 3D view the view control bar has two more buttons:

- **Shadows On** / **Shadows Off**: in the shaded styles the sun lights the model and casts shadows, from the walls onto the floors, from the roof's eaves onto the walls;
- the sun path button: **Sun Path On** draws a compass ring on the ground around the model, with the four points of the compass, the sun's path through the day as an arc over it, and the sun where it is. **Sun Settings...** sets where the sun is:

Mode	What it takes
Still	**Latitude**, **Longitude**, **Time zone (UTC)**, the day and month and the **Time**: the sun's position follows
Lighting	**Azimuth** (degrees clockwise from north) and **Altitude**

Each view has its own sun settings, and the changes can be undone. Shadows are drawn by the 3D window on the graphics card; plans, sections, elevations and exported images do not show them yet.

Plans and their view range

View ▸ Create ▸ Plan Views ▸ Floor Plan opens **New Plan**: pick the levels and the scale, then **OK**. With **Do not duplicate existing views** on, the levels that already have a plan are left out; turn it off to make a second plan of a level.

A plan is a horizontal cut of the model at the **Cut Plane** of its view range. Walls crossing the cut plane are drawn cut, with the cut patterns of their layers' materials at **Medium** and **Fine** detail; lower walls and the floors of the level are seen from above.

To change the view range, select nothing (so that **Properties** shows the view), then **View range ▸ Edit...**. Each plane is measured from a level, with an offset:

Plane	Level
Top	The plan's own level (**Associated Level**), the **Level Above**, a level by name, or **Unlimited**
Cut Plane	Always the plan's own level
Bottom	The plan's own level, the **Level Below** or a level by name
View Depth	As **Bottom**, or **Unlimited**

OK sets the four planes together, as one change. They must stay in order, from the top down (top, cut plane, bottom, view depth): otherwise the window explains what is wrong and stays open. Floors below the bottom, down to the view depth, are

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drawn *beyond* in thin lines; so are floors a little under the bottom, such as a sunken slab, even with the view depth at the bottom.

Light and dark background

Options ▸ Theme ▸ Dark (or **Invert background color**) turns the drawing area dark. As on an inverted background, black lines, text and patterns are drawn light, colours keep their hue, and colour fills such as the rooms' are darkened, so the text over them stays readable. **Options ▸ Interface size** makes the whole interface bigger, from 100 % to 250 %, on top of the screen's own scale: useful on screens with many pixels. It is kept for the next start.

Opening a view from its symbol

Double-click a view's symbol to open its view: a section line or its head, an elevation symbol, a callout's boundary, a level's line in a section or elevation (its floor plan opens), or a view placed on a sheet. The view's window becomes the active one.

Scale, detail level and crop region

The view control bar shows the view's **View Scale** and **Detail Level** (in 3D views too).

- At a smaller scale the model is drawn smaller on paper while text, tags and symbols keep their size on paper: at 1:200 a text covers twice as much of the model as at 1:100.
- At **Coarse** a cut wall is one fill; at **Medium** and **Fine** its layers show, each with its material.

Crop View clips the view to its crop region, **Show Crop Region** draws the region; drag its edges to resize it. To type its size: **Properties ▸ Size Crop ▸ Edit...**, then **Width** and **Height**; the region keeps its centre.

Hiding and isolating

Temporary Hide/Isolate (the glasses on the view control bar) acts on the selected elements, in the active view only, and does not change the project:

Command	Shortcut	What stays visible
Isolate Element	`HI`	Only the selected elements
Hide Element	`HH`	Everything but the selected elements
Isolate Category	`IC`	Only the categories of the selected elements
Hide Category	`HC`	Everything but those categories

The view gets a coloured border. Each use narrows what is shown: hiding one element and then another hides both. **Reset Temporary Hide/Isolate** (`HR`) shows everything again; **Apply Hide/Isolate to View** hides for good what was hidden for now.

To hide for good in the view, select the elements, then right-click ▸ **Hide in view ▸ Elements** or **Category**, or the contextual tab's **View ▸ Hide in View**, or type `EH` (elements) or `VH` (category).

Reveal Hidden Elements (the light bulb on the view control bar, or `RH`) frames the view in magenta and shows what is hidden in magenta, the rest in halftone. A hidden element can then be selected and shown again: right-click ▸ **Unhide in View ▸ Elements** (or **Category**). Click the light bulb again, or type `RH`, to leave.

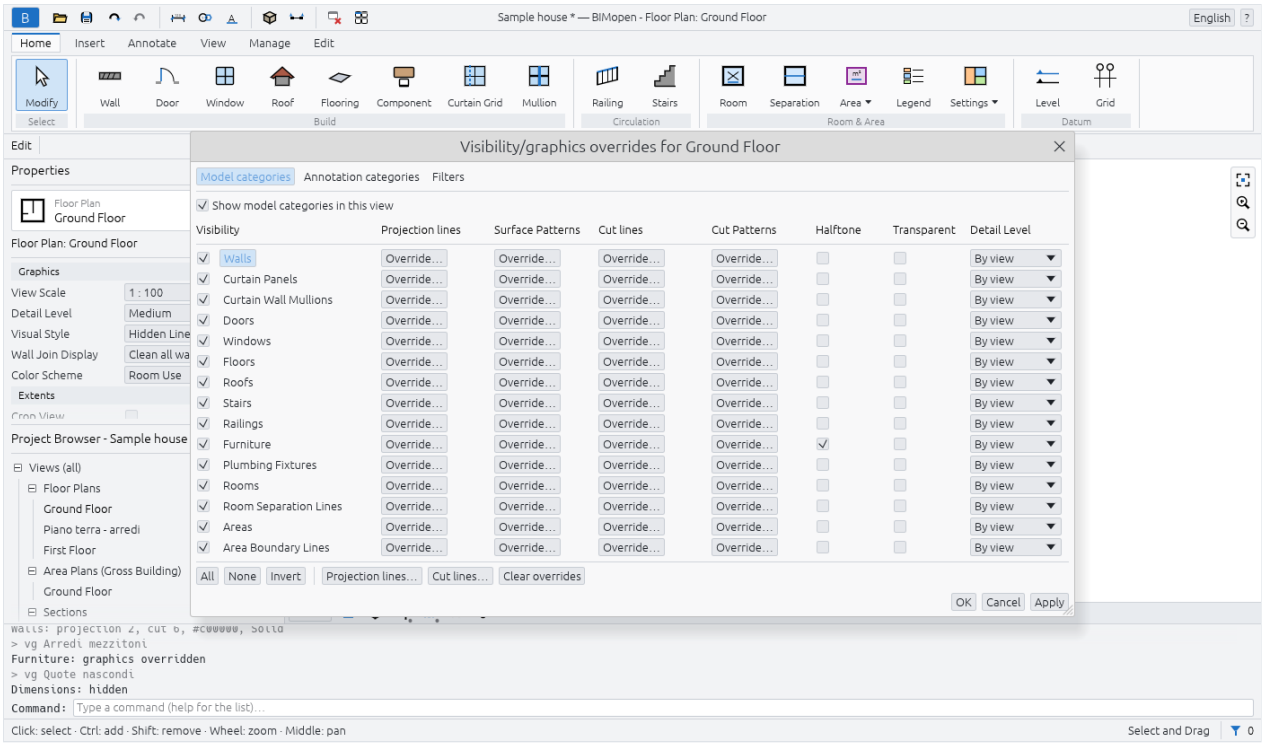
Visibility/Graphics

View ▸ Graphics ▸ Visibility/Graphics (or `VG`, or **Properties ▸ Visibility/graphics overrides ▸ Edit...**) shows, for the active view, one row per category:

- the check box shows or hides the category; **Show model categories in this view** shows or hides them all;
- **Projection lines** and **Cut lines**: **Override...** sets the weight, colour and pattern;
- **Surface Patterns** and **Cut Patterns**: the material's patterns, hidden, in another colour or replaced by another fill pattern;
- **Halftone** blends the lines with the background;
- **Transparent** makes the surfaces see-through in the 3D view;
- **Detail Level** draws the category at another level than the view.

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Clear overrides takes the selected rows back to the object styles. Changes show at once: **Apply** keeps them and the window, **Cancel** (or the window's ×) takes back what was not applied, **OK** keeps them and closes.



One element can have its own graphics in a view: select it, then right-click ▸ **Override graphics in view** ▸ **By Element...** (or the contextual tab's **View** panel). **View-Specific Element Graphics** has **Visible**, **Halftone**, **Transparent**, the surface and cut patterns and the projection and cut lines. They apply only in this view, over the category's and the filters'.

Filters

View ▸ **Graphics** ▸ **Filters** lists the project's filters: **New**, **Duplicate**, **Rename**, **Delete**. A filter has categories and up to four rules on their parameters, all of which an element must meet.

In **Visibility/Graphics** ▸ **Filters**, **Add** applies a filter to the view; its row then sets visibility, lines, **Halftone** and **Transparent** for the elements that pass it. Where filters disagree, the one higher in the list wins: **Up** and **Down** move the selected filter.

View templates

View ▸ **Graphics** ▸ **View templates** ▸ **Create template from current view** keeps the view's scale, detail level, visual style, view range and graphics as a template, by name. **View templates** ▸ **Apply template to current view** gives them to another view of the same kind: a plan (a second plan of a level too), a section or elevation, or a 3D view. A view does not follow later changes of its template until it is applied again, and the graphics of single elements are never part of a template.

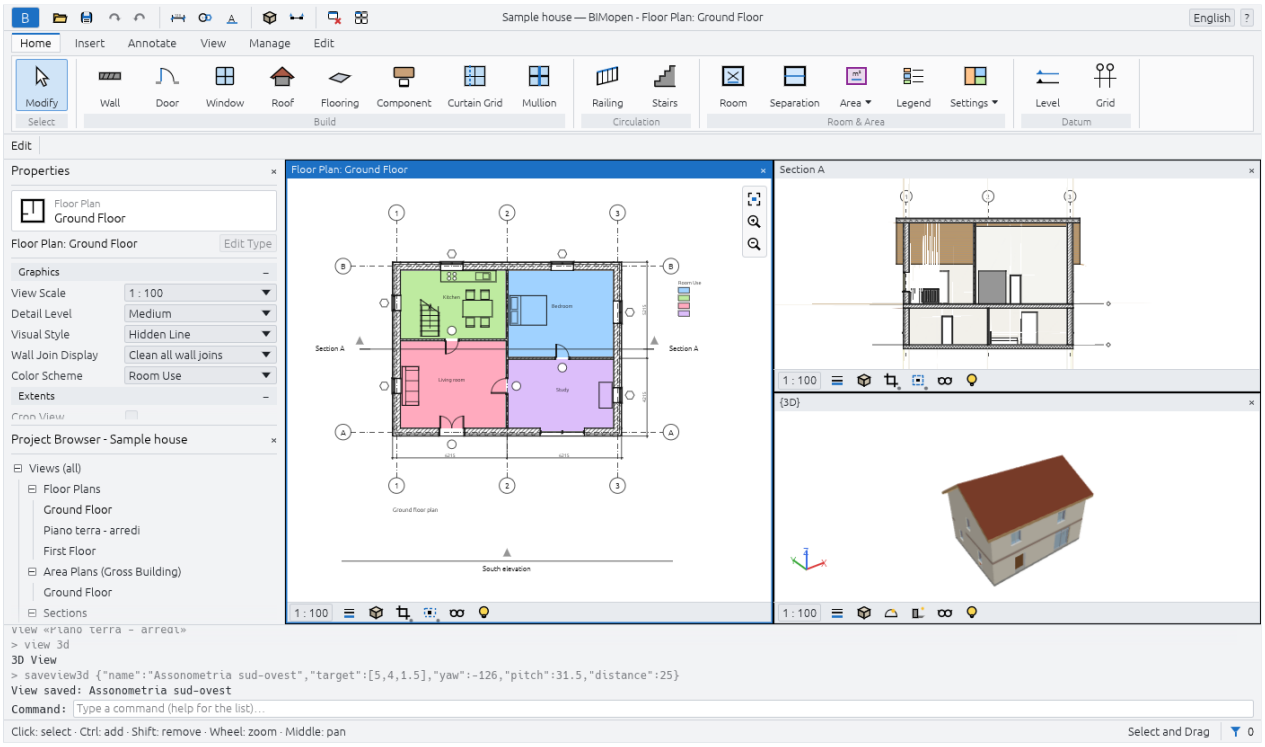
Managing views

Right-click a view in the **Project Browser**:

- **Duplicate View** ▸ **Duplicate** copies the view with its properties; **Duplicate with Detailing** copies its dimensions, text, tags and 2D details too. The copy opens;
- **Rename...** asks for the new name (**Rename View**); names stay unique among views.

View ▸ **Windows** ▸ **Tile** shows all the open views side by side, filling the drawing area: with three windows, the active one on the left at full height and two stacked on the right.

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Annotation and 2D details

This chapter describes dimensions and constraints, text notes, tags, rooms and areas with their colour schemes, legend views, and the 2D drawing tools: detail lines, regions, detail components, repeating details, insulation and drafting views. Annotations belong to the view they are made in: a dimension placed in a plan does not appear in another plan.

Before each click, every tool shows what it would make where the cursor is: the dimension with its value, the note's box, the tag on the element under the cursor, the region a room or area would fill, the line, region, component or insulation being drawn.

Dimensions

Annotate ▸ Dimension holds the dimension tools: **Aligned**, **Linear**, **Angular**, **Radial**, **Arc Length**, and the spot dimensions **Spot Elevation**, **Spot Coordinate** and **Spot Slope**. They work in plans, sections, elevations, drafting views and legends. Pick the dimension type in the type selector while the tool is on; **Type Properties** changes the type, and with it every dimension of that type.

Aligned and linear dimensions

With **Aligned**, the options bar offers which part of a wall is picked (**Wall centerlines**, **Wall faces**, **Center of Core**, **Faces of Core**) and what a click picks:

- **Individual References**: click references one after the other (wall faces or centre lines, grids, door and window edges, detail lines, the edges of legend symbols), then click an empty spot to place the dimension line there. While you choose, the string follows the cursor. Press **TAB** over a wall to step through its references.
- **Entire Walls**: one click dimensions a whole wall. **Options** opens the automatic dimensioning options: **Openings** with their **Centers** or both **Widths**, **Intersecting Walls** and **Intersecting Grids**. A grid that falls on a wall end adds no witness line.

Linear measures along the horizontal or the vertical of the view, between points such as wall ends: where you place the line decides which, and the **space bar** switches between the two.

Angular measures the angle between two walls, grids or lines that meet; the last click picks the sector. **Radial** and **Arc Length** dimension an arc: click it, then where the dimension goes.

Changing a dimension

- Select a dimension and click its value: **Dimension Text** opens. **Use Actual Value** keeps the measure and adds text above, below, before or after it; **Replace with text** shows words instead (a number is refused).
- Drag the blue control under the text to move it away from the line; dragged back near the line, it snaps into place. Text moved far away gets a leader to its segment.
- **Modify | Dimensions ▸ Witness Lines ▸ Edit Witness Lines**: click elements to add witness lines, click an existing witness line to remove it, then click an empty spot to finish.
- Select an element the dimension measures and click a value next to it: type a new distance and press Enter, and the element moves.

The type sets the tick (diagonal, filled arrow or dot), the extensions of the dimension and witness lines, the colour, the text size, offset, background, bold, italic and underline, the units (**Use project settings** or a unit with its decimals), and for linear dimensions the **Dimension String Type**: **Continuous**, **Baseline** (stacked values from the first reference) or **Ordinate** (values from the first reference along one line). **Show Opening Height** writes the height of a door or window under the width measured jamb to jamb. Radial types can drop the **R** prefix.

Temporary dimensions

Select a wall or a grid: temporary dimensions show the distance to the nearest parallel walls or grids. Click a value, type a new one and press Enter to move the element; click the dimension symbol beside it to make it permanent. While a door or window is placed, temporary dimensions show its distance to the nearest walls. With several elements selected none are shown, and the options bar offers **Activate Dimensions** to show them for all the selected elements.

Constraints

Select a dimension: a padlock is shown on each segment. Click it to lock the segment: the distance then holds when either element moves, and a move that would break it is refused. Click it again, or right-click it ▸ **Toggle Lock**, to unlock. A string of two segments or more shows **EQ**: click it and the references become equally spaced, and stay so when one of them moves. **Equality display** in the properties shows the values instead of **EQ**.

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Selecting an element a constraint holds shows the constraint as blue dashed lines, unless the category **Constraints** is hidden in **Visibility/Graphics**. Deleting a dimension that holds a constraint asks what to do: **OK** deletes the dimension and keeps the constraint; **Delete Elements** deletes both. **Modify ▸ Align** with its padlock closed is a constraint too.

Spot dimensions

- **Spot Elevation**: in a plan, click a floor, a roof or the level; in a section, any point. The value is in metres with its sign.
- **Spot Coordinate**: the north and east coordinates of a point in a plan.
- **Spot Slope**: the slope of a roof pitch in a plan, or of a sloped line in a section, with an arrow pointing down.

The options bar offers **Leader** and, with a leader, **Shoulder**: with no leader one click places the spot; with a leader, click the point and then the text; with a shoulder, the point, the bend and the text. While you hover, the value shows at the cursor.

Text

Annotate ▸ Text ▸ Text (`TX`): click where the note goes and type; Enter starts a new line. A click gives a note that does not wrap; dragging gives it a width, and the words wrap in it. Clicking elsewhere finishes the note, and **Esc** ends the tool. The text size is on paper: the note keeps its printed size at any view scale.

The **Format** panel sets, before placing or on a selected note:

- the leader: **No Leader**, **One Segment** (click the tip, then the note), **Two Segments** (tip, elbow, note) or **Curved**;
- the alignment, left, centre or right, and **Bold**, **Italic** and **Underline** (Ctrl+B, Ctrl+I, Ctrl+U while typing), which apply to the whole note;
- on a selected note, **Add Left Straight Leader** and the other three leader buttons, and **Remove Last Leader**.

On a selected note, drag the cross to move the box (the leader tips stay), the round side controls to change its width, and the rotation control to turn it. Double-click inside it to edit the words. Its properties include **Arc Leaders**, **Left Attachment** and **Right Attachment**, and **Keep Readable**, which never shows it upside down. The text type sets the colour (of text, border and leaders), the background (**Opaque** masks what is behind), **Show Border** with its offset, the leader arrowhead, the size, bold, italic and underline. **Duplicate...** in **Type Properties** makes a new text type.

Annotate ▸ Text ▸ Find/Replace finds words in the notes of the current selection, the current view or the whole project (**Scope:**), with options for case and whole words. **Find All** lists the matches with the view they are in; **Replace** changes the first, **Replace All** every one.

Tags

Annotate ▸ Tag ▸ Tag by Category (`TG`): hover an element (a door, window, wall, room or area) and click to tag it. The options bar sets **Horizontal** or **Vertical**, the **Leader** and its length; the **space bar** switches the orientation, while placing or on a selected tag. Door and window tools have **Tag on Placement**, so each new door or window comes with its tag.

Tag All opens **Tag All Not Tagged**: tick the categories, the tag type of each, the leader and the orientation, for all the elements of the view or only the selected ones; only elements with no tag get one.

Double-click a tag to edit what it shows: a room's name, a door's mark, a wall's type mark. A tag takes another type of its own category from the type selector. Room tag types choose whether they show the number, the area and the volume.

Rooms

Home ▸ Room & Area ▸ Room (`RM`), then click inside a region enclosed by walls or room separators: the room fills it, around free-standing walls too. In the options bar:

- **Upper Limit** and **Offset**: the room reaches that level plus the offset (4000 mm by default); a higher level gives a room over several storeys, such as an atrium;
- **Tag on Placement**, on by default, with the tag's orientation and leader;
- **Room**: **New**, or a room that is not placed, to put it back;
- **Highlight Boundaries**: walls and separators that bound rooms turn orange, and the warning lists them.

A room placed in open space is kept with a warning, and takes its shape once the space is closed; a second room in a region already taken is marked **Redundant Room** and not counted twice.

Room Separator draws lines that split a space into rooms without walls. A wall bounds rooms while its **Room Bounding** property is on. Floors and roofs above cap the room's volume.

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Deleting a room removes it from the plan but keeps it in the project, **Not Placed**, with its data; its tags go with it. Deleting a room tag leaves the room. A room tag dragged out of its room asks whether to **Move to Room**.

Rooms show through their tags. In **Visibility/Graphics**, **Rooms** has **Interior Fill** and **Datum** (the cross lines). **Settings ▸ Area and Volume Computations** opens on **Computations**: the room boundary at the wall finish, centre, core layer or core centre, and **Areas and Volumes** to compute volumes too (by default only areas; the volume is always measured to the wall finish). Its second tab is **Area Schemes**.

Areas

Areas belong to an area scheme: **Gross Building** (which cannot be deleted) and **Rentable** come with every project, and **Area Schemes ▸ New** adds more.

1. **Room & Area ▸ Area ▸ Area Plan**: pick the scheme and the levels. Answer **Yes** to draw area boundary lines along the exterior walls, **No** to draw them yourself.
2. **Area ▸ Area Boundary Line**: draw the boundaries, or pick walls; with the area rules on, an exterior wall of a gross plan gives its outer face.
3. **Area ▸ Area**: click inside the boundaries. The area is tagged when placed; **Tag ▸ Area Tag** tags it later.

Deleting an area leaves it in the project, not placed, without its tags.

Colour schemes

A colour scheme fills the rooms or areas of a plan by a value (name, number, department, area type) or by ranges of area. Set it in the plan's **Color Scheme** property; **(none)** turns it off. **Settings ▸ Color Schemes** (**Edit Color Scheme**) creates and duplicates schemes and edits the title, the parameter, the values with their colour and visibility, their order and the ranges. **Color scheme location**, a view property, draws the fills in the **Background** (under the model) or in the **Foreground** (over the model, under the annotations).

Room & Area ▸ Legend places the legend of the plan's scheme: a swatch and a label for each value. Its **Values displayed** are **By view** (those in the plan) or **All**, and **Columns** flows the swatches into several columns. A plan can have several legends; deleting one leaves the scheme.

Legend views

View ▸ Legends ▸ Legend opens **New Legend View**: a name and a scale. The legend opens and is listed under **Legends** in the Project Browser. **Annotate ▸ Component ▸ Legend Component** places the symbol of a type: in the options bar, the type, the **View** it is seen from (a wall in plan or section; a floor or roof in section or plan; a door, window or component in plan, front or back) and the **Host Length**, the piece of wall a door or window sits in. Legend components draw at the legend's detail level, can be moved and dimensioned (the edges of doors, windows and components; walls, floors and roofs are not), and are not counted by schedules. Text, detail lines and regions work as in a drafting view. A legend can be placed on several sheets.

Detail lines and regions

Annotate ▸ Detail ▸ Detail line (`DL`) draws lines in the open view only, in the line style of the **Line style** panel, with the shapes of the **Draw** panel; **Chain** starts each line where the last ended.

Region ▸ Filled region sketches a boundary with lines or a rectangle; **Finish Edit Mode** makes the region in the current region type, which sets its fill pattern, colour and background (**Opaque** hides what is behind). **Region ▸ Masking Region** makes a region in the paper colour that hides what is beneath it. A region shows its **Area**.

Detail components, repeating details and insulation

- **Component ▸ Detail component**: a 2D symbol (brick, block, timber, steel section, insulation board, break line) placed in a drafting or detail view; the **space bar** turns it while placing.
- **Component ▸ Repeating detail**: click a start and an end; the type sets the repeated component, the **Layout** (fill the available space, fixed distance, fixed number, maximum spacing), the **Spacing**, **Inside** and the rotation within the pattern. The instance has the **Number** when the layout is a fixed number.
- **Insulation**: click two points; **Width** in the options bar, the insulation width and the bulge ratio in its properties.

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Draw order

Select detail items only: **Arrange** offers **Bring to Front**, **Bring Forward**, **Send to Back** and **Send Backward**. Detail items always draw over the model, and a new one goes on top. **Undo** restores the previous order.

Drafting views

View ▸ Create ▸ Drafting view asks for a name and a scale (or a custom one). The view opens and is listed under **Drafting views**; everything drawn in it is 2D, with no model behind it. It can go on one sheet. **Duplicate View ▸ Duplicate with Detailing** copies a view with its detail items, text, dimensions and legend components.

At the command line

Every tool has its command: `dim`, `lineardim`, `angulardim`, `radialdim`, `arcdim`, `spotelevation`, `text`, `findreplace`, `tag`, `room`, `roomsep`, `areaplan`, `areaboundary`, `area`, `colorscheme`, `legend`, `legendview`, `legendcomponent`, `detailline`, `region`, `mask`, `draworder`, `lock`, `eq`. `help` followed by a command shows its usage; Keyboard shortcuts lists the typed shortcuts.

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Sheets, schedules and printing

This chapter describes how the project is documented: sheets and their title blocks, the views placed on them, revisions, schedules, printed drawings and exported images.

Sheets

A sheet is a drawing to print: a title block and the views placed on it. Sheets are listed under **Sheets (all)** in the Project Browser, by number.

Creating a sheet

View ➤ Sheet Composition ➤ Sheet opens **New Sheet**: choose a title block (its paper size is shown), **None**, or one of the placeholder sheets of the sheet list. **OK** creates the sheet with the next free number (**A101**, **A102**...) and opens it.

Right-click a sheet in the Project Browser ➤ **Rename...** to change its number and name in **Sheet Title**. The other parameters of the sheet are in the **Properties** palette: **Sheet Number**, **Sheet Name**, **Sheet Issue Date**, **Drawn By**, **Checked By**, **Designed By**, **Approved By**, **Appears In Sheet List**, its guide grid and its revisions. Several sheets picked together in the Project Browser (with `Ctrl` or `Shift`) are changed together: the palette shows the values they share.

Manage ➤ Settings ➤ Project information sets what every sheet shows: **Project Issue Date**, **Project Status**, **Client Name**, **Project Address**, **Project Name** and **Project Number**.

Title blocks

The title block shows the project's information, the sheet's number and name, the people and the dates, the current revision and the scale (**As indicated** when the views have different scales); above it, a table lists the sheet's revisions with their number, description and date. A double click on one of its fields types the value in place.

- Click a line of the title block to pick it: the type selector changes it to another paper size, `Del` removes it (the sheet and its views stay).
- **View ➤ Sheet Composition ➤ Title Block** inserts one on the open sheet: choose it in the type selector, its frame follows the cursor, click to place it.
- **Edit Type** shows its **Sheet width** and **Sheet height**; **Duplicate...** makes a new paper size.

Views on sheets

Drag a view from the Project Browser onto the sheet, or use **View ➤ Sheet Composition ➤ View** (**Views**, then **Add View to Sheet**): the view follows the cursor at its scale, and a click places it as a viewport. A view goes on one sheet only; a schedule on several.

A picked viewport:

- moves with the mouse or the arrow keys, unless it is pinned (**Pin**); near another view, its title lines up with the other's and a dashed line shows it;
- has its **View Scale**, its **Title on Sheet** (also typed by double-clicking the title) and its **Rotation on Sheet** (90° clockwise or counter-clockwise; the title stays horizontal);
- shows the end of its title line, which can be dragged;
- takes a viewport type from the type selector: **No Title**, **Title w/ Line** or **Title w/o Line**, or a type of your own (**Show Title**, **Show Extension Line**, line weight, colour and pattern of the line);
- leaves the sheet with `Del`; the view stays in the project.

Activate View (on the **Modify | Viewports** tab or the right button) edits the view where it is on the sheet, the rest of the sheet in halftone; **Deactivate View** goes back to the sheet. A view turned on its sheet cannot be activated: take its rotation off first. A double click on a view opens it in its own window.

Guide grids

View ➤ Sheet Composition ➤ Guide Grid asks for a name and covers the sheet with a grid. Pick it to drag its corners or to set its **Guide spacing**; the sheet's **Guide Grid** parameter shows the same grid on other sheets, or none. Views dragged near the grid's lines snap onto them. The grid is never printed.

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Sheet list

View ➤ Create ➤ Schedules ➤ Sheet List makes a schedule of the sheets: number, name and any other field. Sheets with **Appears In Sheet List** unticked are left out. **Rows ➤ New** adds a placeholder sheet: a row that is not a sheet yet and is not in the Project Browser. **Filter placeholder sheets** shows every row, hides the placeholders or shows only them. A placeholder chosen in **New Sheet** becomes a real sheet.

Revisions

View ➤ Sheet Composition ➤ Sheet Issues/Revisions lists the revisions of the project, one per row: **Sequence**, **Numbering** (**Numeric**, **Alphabetic** or none), **Date**, **Description**, **Issued**, **Issued to**, **Issued by** and **Show**. **Add** adds one; a row picked by its sequence number is merged into the one above or below (its clouds go with it) or moved up and down. **Numbering** is **Per Project** or **Per Sheet** (the place of the revision among the sheet's revisions); **Alphabetical order ➤ Options...** sets the letters used. An issued revision cannot be changed, and neither can its clouds, until **Issued** is unticked.

Annotate ➤ Detail ➤ Revision Cloud draws a cloud in a plan, a section, a drafting view or on a sheet: click its corners (or draw a rectangle), then **Finish Edit Mode**. The cloud takes the latest revision not issued; picked, it shows its **Revision** (to change), its number, date and people, its **Mark** and **Comments**. **Show** of a revision draws its clouds and tags, keeps them but does not draw them, or hides them.

A sheet lists the revisions of the clouds of its views and of its own clouds. Its **Revisions on Sheet** (in the Properties palette, **Edit...**) adds other revisions to the list.

Schedules

A schedule is a table of the elements of the model, and a view like the others: it opens in a window of the drawing area, is tiled, cascaded and switched with plans, sections and 3D views, and is listed under **Schedules/Quantities** in the Project Browser. It follows every change of the model at once, and every change made in it changes the model.

Creating a schedule

View ➤ Create ➤ Schedules ➤ Schedule/Quantities opens **New Schedule**: choose a category, a name (the default follows the category until one is typed) and **Schedule building components** or **Schedule keys**. **OK** opens **Schedule Properties**; its second **OK** creates the schedule and opens its view. **Material Takeoff** in the same menu lists the materials of the layers of walls, floors and roofs.

Schedule Properties

The dialog opens again from the **Properties** palette of the schedule (each tab has its **Edit...** button) or from the right button on the schedule in the Project Browser. Its tabs:

Tab	What it sets
Fields	The columns, chosen from **Available fields:** and put in order; the fields of the rooms the elements are in; **Add Parameter...** for a project or shared parameter; **Calculated Value...** for a formula (with `+ - * / ^`, `sqrt`, `round`, `IF`, `AND`, `OR`, `NOT` and units) or a percentage
Filter	Up to four criteria, all of which an element must meet
Sorting/ Grouping	Up to four sort levels, each with **Header**, footer and **Blank line**; the grand totals; **Itemize every instance** (off: one row per type)
Formatting	Per field: heading, orientation, alignment, hidden field, **Format...** (units, rounding, symbol), totals and **Conditional Format...** (a background colour where a value meets a test)
Appearance	Grid lines and outline with their line styles, the title and the column headers, a blank row, **Header text** and **Body text** (size, **Bold**, **Italic**); shown when the schedule is on a sheet

Working in a schedule view

- A cell edits the element, or its type for a type parameter; every edit is one step of undo.
- A row selects its elements in every view. **Highlight in model** on the **Modify | Schedule/Quantities** tab opens **Show Elements in View**, which brings a plan forward framed on them; **Show** goes on to the next view.
- **Rows ➤ Delete** deletes the elements of the selected rows, after asking.
- Headings picked together are joined under a common heading with **Group**, and parted with **Ungroup**; **Hide column** and **Unhide all columns** work on the column picked.

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Schedules on sheets

Drag a schedule from the Project Browser onto a sheet. Selected on the sheet, it shows its controls: the Z on the right edge of a segment splits it in two, the arrow in the middle of a segment moves it (dropped on the segment beside it, the two join), the dot at the bottom of a segment moves its last row, and the triangles at the top of the columns set their widths. A double click, or **Edit Schedule** on the right button, opens the schedule view. The same schedule can go on several sheets.

Key schedules and material takeoffs

A key schedule (**Schedule keys** in **New Schedule**) defines named sets of values, one row per key, added and deleted with **Rows**. Its **Key Name** becomes a parameter of the category: choosing a key for an element gives it all the values of that row.

A material takeoff lists, for each element, the materials of its layers with their area and volume; its fields can be sorted, grouped and totalled like any other.

Project and shared parameters

Manage ➤ Settings ➤ Project Parameters adds parameters to the elements of some categories, or to their types, with a name, a type of value and the group they show in the Properties palette.

Manage ➤ Settings ➤ Shared Parameters opens **Edit Shared Parameters**: the shared parameter file in use (**Browse...**, **Create...**), its groups and the parameters of each group. A shared parameter keeps its name and type, and has an identifier of its own, so that several projects add the same parameter. In **Parameter Properties**, choose **Shared parameter** and **Select...** to add one to the project; **Export...** writes a shared parameter of the project back to the file.

Exporting and reusing schedules

- **Application menu ➤ Export ➤ Reports ➤ Schedule...** writes the schedule as delimited text: **Export Schedule** sets the field delimiter, the text qualifier and which headings and group rows go in the file.
- **Create view template from view...** on the right button of a schedule makes a view template with its fields, filter, sorting, formatting and appearance; **Apply view template...** gives them to another schedule.
- **Save to New File...** on the right button writes the schedule's setup, without the elements, to a file of its own. **Insert ➤ Import ➤ Insert from File ➤ Insert Views from File...** brings the schedules of another project into this one, with their project parameters.

Printing

Printing writes PDF files: on the desktop they are saved where you choose, in the browser they are downloaded.

The Print dialog

`Ctrl+P`, or **application menu ➤ Print ➤ Print...**, opens **Print**:

- **File**: the name of the file and, when several views or sheets are printed, **Combine multiple selected views/sheets into a single file** (one page each) or **Create separate files** (one file each, named after the sheet or view).
- **Print Range**: **Current window**, **Visible portion of current window** (only what the window shows), or **Selected views/sheets** with **Select...**.
- **Reverse print order** prints the last page first.
- **Settings**: the print settings in use, changed with **Settings...**; **Preview** shows the pages.

Plans, sections, elevations, drafting views and sheets print as drawings; the 3D window prints as an image of the view; a schedule prints its table on a page. The page is always white, elements hidden temporarily in a window are printed, and each printed sheet carries the date and time of the print.

View/sheet sets

Select... opens **View/Sheet Set**: tick the sheets and views to print (**Show** sheets, views or both; **Check all**, **Check none**). A set is saved by name with **Save As...** and kept in the project; **Save**, **Reset**, **Rename...** and **Delete** manage the saved sets, and the name list picks one again.

Print Setup

application menu ➤ Print ➤ Print Setup..., or **Settings...** in **Print**, sets:

Setting	What it does
	The paper (A0 to A4, or the sheet's own size) and its orientation

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Setting	What it does
Size and **Orientation**	
Paper Placement	**Center**, or an offset from the lower-left corner
Hidden line views	**Vector Processing** or **Raster Processing** (the pages as images, at the raster quality chosen)
Zoom	**Fit to page**, or a percentage of the real size
Colors	**Black Lines**, **Grayscale** or **Colour**
Options	**Show view links in blue**, **Hide unreferenced view tags**, **Hide crop boundaries**, **Replace halftone with thin lines**

Settings are saved by name with **Save As...**, and kept in the project. Closing the dialog after changing saved settings asks whether to save the changes; **No** keeps them for this session only.

Print Preview

application menu ➤ Print ➤ Print Preview, or **Preview** in **Print**, shows the pages as they will print, in their colours: **Previous Page** and **Next Page** go through them, the wheel zooms and dragging pans; **Print...** prints, **Close** goes back.

Exporting images

application menu ➤ Export ➤ Images and animations ➤ Image... opens **Export Image**:

- the file name and the **Export Range**: the current window, its visible portion, or the views and sheets chosen (one file each);
- the **Image Size**: **Fit view(s)/sheet(s) to** a number of pixels across or down, or a zoom percentage of the real size at a resolution;
- the options, as for printing: view links in blue, crop boundaries and unreferenced view tags hidden;
- the **Format** of views without shading and of shaded views: PNG, JPEG, BMP or TIFF.

The 3D window is exported as it is shown, with its visual style.

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Command line and MCP

Everything you do in BIMopen is a command. A click on **Wall** and two points in the plan run the same `wall` command you can type yourself. This chapter describes the command line of the window, the `bimopen-cli` program, which runs the same commands without a window, and the MCP server, through which an AI agent can model, check and render a project.

The command line in the window

The command line sits under the drawing area. Its upper part is the log; its last row is where you type.

- You do not need to click it first: whatever you type while no other field is being edited goes there.
- `Enter` runs the line. The command is echoed in the log after a `>`, followed by its result; an error is shown in red and changes nothing.
- `Up` and `Down` bring back the lines typed before.
- On the left of the row, the prompt says what is expected: `Command:` when no tool is active, or the request of the active tool, such as `WALL next point [Esc to finish]:`.
- `help` lists every command with a line of description; `help wall` shows the usage of one. **?** ▸ **Commands** in the title bar does the same as `help`.

Typed shortcuts start the tools

A command typed **without arguments** starts the interactive tool, as if you clicked its button: `WA` (or `wall`) starts the wall tool, `DR` the door tool, `VG` opens Visibility/Graphics. The same command **with arguments** does the work at once, without the tool: `wall 0,0 5,0` draws a wall from the origin to 5 m along x.

Command names, their short forms and their arguments are the same in every language of the interface; most also accept an Italian name, such as `muro` for `wall`. Parameter names, type names and view names follow the language of the interface: in English you type `set Unconnected Height 2.7m`, in Italian `set Altezza non collegata 2.7m`. The keyboard shortcuts chapter lists every short form.

Points and lengths

You type	It means
`3,4`	The point x = 3 m, y = 4 m
`@2,0`	2 m along x and 0 along y from the previous point
`@4<90`	4 m from the previous point, at 90° (angles counter-clockwise from the x axis)
`2.7m`, `270cm`, `2700mm`	A length with its unit
`2.7` or `2,7`	A length in metres: at the command line a number without unit is in metres

For example, `wall 0,0 @6,0 @4<90 0,4 c` draws a 6 × 4 m rectangle; the final `c` closes it.

> Warning
>
> At the command line `set Unconnected Height 2700` means 2700 **metres**. Write the unit: `2700mm`. In the Properties palette, instead, a number without unit is in the project's units, millimetres in a new project.

Arguments in JSON

Every command also takes its arguments as a JSON object, which gives access to all its options. The usage line of `help` lists them:

```
wall 0,0 10,0 {"height":3.2,"location":"Linea d'asse del muro"}
roof walls {"slope":30,"overhang":0.5}
sheet A102 Plans {"title_block":"A3"}
export doors.csv {"schedule":"doors"}
```

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Commands you will use often

Command	What it does
`new`, `sample`	A new project, the sample project
`open house.bimopen`, `save house.bimopen`	Opens and saves a project
`undo`, `redo`	Undoes and redoes the last change
`view 3d`, `view Ground Floor`	Opens the default 3D view, or the plan of a level
`wall`, `door`, `window`, `floor`, `roof`	Model elements: see the usage with `help`
`select walls`, `select all`, `deselect`	Selects by category, everything, nothing
`set <parameter> <value>`	Sets a parameter of the selection, as in the Properties palette
`type <type name>`	Changes the type of the selection, or of the next element
`move 1,0`, `copy 0,3`, `rotate 90`	Modifies the selection
`delete`	Deletes the selection
`list walls`, `params 102`, `info`	Lists elements, the parameters of one, a summary of the project
`schedule doors`	Shows a schedule at the command line
`export house.ifc`	Exports IFC, SVG, PNG or CSV, by the file's extension

Every element has a number, its id, shown in brackets after it is created: `Door «Single swing door 80x210» in wall 102 (106)`. Commands accept it where they need an element: `params 106`, `delete 106`.

bimopen-cli

`bimopen-cli` runs BIMopen without a window: to convert files, to build a project from a script, to check a model, or to serve agents over MCP. Build it with `cargo build --release -p bimopen-cli`.

```
bimopen-cli info <file>
bimopen-cli convert <in> <out> [--level NAME] [--view 3d] [--schedule walls|doors|windows|floors|rooms|materials]
bimopen-cli run [<file> | --sample] [--cmd LINE]… [--script FILE] [--save FILE] [--export FILE]…
bimopen-cli commands
bimopen-cli mcp [<file> | --sample]
```

Subcommand	What it does
`info <file>`	A summary of the project and, in JSON, its levels, element counts and active view
`convert <in> <out>`	Opens `<in>` (`.bimopen` or `.rvt`) and writes `<out>`: `.ifc`, `.svg` or `.png` of a plan (the lowest level, or `--level`), `.png` of the 3D view (`--view 3d`), `.csv` of a schedule (`--schedule`), or `.bimopen`
`run`	Opens a file, the sample, or a new project, then runs the options in order: `--cmd` one line, `--script` a file of lines (empty lines and lines starting with `#` are skipped), `--save` and `--export` a file
`commands`	Every command, with its description and usage
`mcp`	The MCP server on standard input and output
`--version`	The version

The messages are in the language of the environment variable `BIMOPEN_LANG` (`it`, `en`, `de`, `fr`, `es`, `ar`), or of the system (`LANG`), or Italian. `bimopen-cli` ends with code 0 when everything worked, 1 when a command failed (the message says which), and 2 when the arguments are wrong (it prints the usage).

```
export BIMOPEN_LANG=en
bimopen-cli run --script house.txt --save house.bimopen --export house.ifc
bimopen-cli convert house.bimopen plan.svg
bimopen-cli convert house.bimopen doors.csv --schedule doors
bimopen-cli convert house.bimopen first.png --level "First Floor"
bimopen-cli convert house.bimopen house-3d.png --view 3d
bimopen-cli convert project.rvt project.bimopen
```

A script is a text file with one command per line, exactly as typed at the command line:

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```
# a small house
wall 0,0 10,0 10,6 0,6 c
door 5,0
window 10,3
floor walls
roof walls
```

The schedules are written as CSV with `;` between the columns, the headings in the language of the messages and a total row at the end.

MCP: BIMopen for AI agents

The Model Context Protocol (MCP) lets an AI agent use programs as tools. `bimopen-cli mcp` is an MCP server: it speaks JSON-RPC 2.0 on standard input and output, one message per line, and keeps one project open for the whole conversation. Without a file it starts from a new project; `--sample` starts from the sample house.

To add it to an agent, give the agent the command to start. For example, in Claude Code:

```
claude mcp add bimopen -- bimopen-cli mcp --sample
```

or, in a client configured with JSON:

```
{ "mcpServers": { "bimopen": { "command": "bimopen-cli", "args": ["mcp", "--sample"] } } }
```

The server offers seven tools:

Tool	Arguments	What it does
`command_line`	`line`	Types a line at the command line, exactly as a person would
`execute`	`command`, `args`	Runs a command with its arguments in JSON
`inspect_model`	–	A summary: levels, element counts, active view, selection
`query_elements`	`category` (optional)	The elements, with id, category and name: `walls`, `doors`, `windows`, `floors`, `rooms`, `roomseps`, `grids`, `levels`, `types`
`get_params`	`id`	Every parameter of an element
`schedule`	`kind`	A schedule: `walls`, `doors`, `windows`, `floors`, `rooms` or `materials`
`render`	`view`, `width`, `height`, `yaw`, `pitch`	A PNG image of a view: `3d`, the name of a level for its plan, of a section, elevation, callout or drafting view, or the number or name of a sheet; `yaw` and `pitch` turn the 3D camera, in degrees

The answers carry the message of the command and, when there is one, its data in JSON, such as the ids of the elements created. An agent can check its own work by asking for a render.

> **Tip**
>
> Ask the agent to render the plan and the 3D view after each step: it sees what it built and corrects itself.

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Keyboard shortcuts

BIMopen has two kinds of shortcuts: **keys**, such as `Ctrl+Z`, which act at once, and **typed shortcuts**, such as `WA`, which you type letter by letter and confirm with `Enter`, like any command. Typed shortcuts are the same in every language.

On macOS, `Cmd` takes the place of `Ctrl`.

Keys

Key	What it does
`Ctrl+Z`	Undoes the last change
`Ctrl+Y` or `Ctrl+Shift+Z`	Redoes the change just undone
`Ctrl+S`	Saves the project; a project never saved asks for a file name
`Ctrl+P`	Opens **Print**
`Ctrl+A`	Selects the elements of the open plan's level, or of the whole model in a 3D view
`Del`	Deletes the selected elements, and the elements they host
`Home`	Fits the whole view in its window
`F1`	Opens the page of this manual about the open dialog, the ribbon button under the mouse or the active tool
`Esc`	Cancels the step in progress; pressed again, ends the tool; with no tool, clears the selection
`Enter`	Runs the line typed at the command line; confirms a value in the Properties palette
`Up` / `Down`	At the command line, the lines typed before
`Space`	While drawing walls, swaps the exterior and interior side; while placing a component or a detail component, rotates it
`Shift`	While drawing, keeps segments horizontal or vertical (or frees them, when **Ortho** is on); with a click or a window, takes elements out of the selection; while dragging, frees a joined wall or keeps the move horizontal or vertical
`Ctrl` + click	Adds an element to the selection; held when a drag starts, places a copy
`Tab` / `Shift+Tab`	Highlights the next (previous) element under the cursor, or a chain of joined walls and lines
`Ctrl+Left`	Selects again what was selected before
`Left` `Right` `Up` `Down`	Move the selection a small step; with `Shift`, ten steps

`Ctrl+Z`, `Ctrl+Y`, `Ctrl+A`, `Del` and `Home` act on the model only while you are not typing in a field: in a field they act on the text.

In a floor, roof, stair or railing sketch, `Esc` (or a double-click) also finishes the sketch when it has enough points.

In the **Text Note** dialog, `Ctrl+Enter` inserts the note and `Esc` cancels it.

Mouse

	In plans and sections	In 3D views
Wheel	Zoom at the cursor	Zoom
Middle button, drag	Pan	Pan; with `Shift`, orbit
Left button, drag	Selection window (left to right: inside; right to left: touching), or moves the selected elements	The same
Right button	Context menu; with a tool active, cancels the step	The same; dragging, orbit
Double-click	Finishes a sketch	–

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Typed shortcuts

Type the letters while no field is being edited, then press `Enter`. Without arguments, a shortcut starts the tool or opens the dialog; with arguments, it runs the command at once (see Command line and MCP).

Modelling

Shortcut	Command	Starts
`WA` or `W`	`wall`	Wall
`DR`	`door`	Door
`WN`	`window`	Window
`SB`	`floor`	Floor (the **Flooring** button)
`RF`	`roof`	Roof
`CM`	`component`	Component
`ST`	`stair`	Stairs
`RA`	`railing`	Railing
`CG`	`curtaingrid`	Curtain grid
`MU`	`mullion`	Mullion
`CP`	`curtainpanel`	Curtain wall panel
`GR`	`grid`	Grid
`RM`	`room`	Room
`RS`	`roomsep`	Room separation
`PA`	`areaplan`	The **Area Plan** dialog
`CA`	`areaboundary`	Area boundary line
–	`area`	Area
`LG`	`legend`	Color fill legend
`SC`	`colorscheme`	The **Color Schemes** dialog

Modifying

Shortcut	Command	Starts
`MV` or `M`	`move`	Move
`CO`	`copy`	Copy
`RO`	`rotate`	Rotate
`MM`	`mirror`	Mirror - Pick Axis
`DM`	`mirror`	Mirror - Draw Axis
`AR`	`array`	Array
`OF`	`offset`	Offset
`AL`	`align`	Align
`TR`	`trim`	Trim/Extend to Corner
`SL`	`split`	Split Element
`SG`	`split`	Split with Gap
`RE`	`resize`	Scale
`PN`	`pin`	Pins the selection
`UP`	`unpin`	Unpins the selection
`SA`	`selectinstances`	Selects all instances of the selection's types visible in the view

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Shortcut	Command	Starts
`DEL`	`delete`	Deletes the selection
`U`	`undo`	Undoes the last change

Annotating and detailing

Shortcut	Command	Starts
`DI`	`dim`	Aligned dimension
`DL`	`lineardim`	Linear dimension
`DA`	`angulardim`	Angular dimension
`TX`	`text`	Text
`TG`	`tag`	Tags the untagged doors and windows of the level
–	`detailline`	Detail line
`RG`	`region`	Filled region
–	`mask`	Masking region
`CD`	`detailcomponent`	Detail component
`RD`	`repeatingdetail`	Repeating detail
`IS`	`insulation`	Insulation

> Note
>
> The tip of the **Detail line** button shows `DL`, but `DL` starts the linear dimension, as the tip of **Linear** says. To start the detail line by typing, use `detailline`.

Views and settings

Shortcut	Command	Starts or opens
`SE`	`section`	Section
`EL`	`elevation`	Elevation
`DT`	`callout`	Callout (the **Detail** button)
`DS`	`splitsegment`	Split Segment of a section
`VD`	`draftingview`	The **Drafting view** dialog
`PP`	`floorplan`	The **Floor Plan** dialog
`DV`	`duplicateview`	Duplicates the active view
`VG` or `VV`	`vg`	**Visibility/Graphics**
`WF`, `HL`, `SD`	–	**Wireframe**, **Hidden Line**, **Shaded**: the visual style of the active view
`HH`, `HI`	–	**Hide Element**, **Isolate Element** for now
`HC`, `IC`	–	**Hide Category**, **Isolate Category** for now
`HR`	–	**Reset Temporary Hide/Isolate**
`EH`, `VH`	–	**Hide in view**: the selected elements, their category
`RH`	–	**Reveal Hidden Elements**, on and off
`TL`	`thinlines`	**Thin lines**, on and off
`SO`	`objectstyle`	**Object styles**
`MA`	`material`	**Materials**
`UN`	`units`	**Project units**
`PU`	`purge`	**Purge unused**

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Shortcut	Command	Starts or opens
–	`filter`	**Filters**
–	`viewtemplate`	**View templates**
–	`applytemplate`	Apply a view template to the active view
–	`linestyle`	**Line styles**
–	`fillpattern`	**Fill patterns**
–	`saveview3d`	Saves the {3D} view with a name
–	`renameview`	Renames the active view

The commands with **–** have no short form, but their whole name works the same way. `help` lists every command and its short forms.

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Troubleshooting

This chapter collects situations that can surprise you, and what to do about them. It grows with the manual: each area of the realignment adds its own.

Starting BIMopen

The web app shows «BIMopen non si è avviato» and an error

The browser could not give BIMopen a graphics surface: the message ends with `webgl2 not available` or with a WebGPU error. BIMopen in the browser needs WebGPU or WebGL2.

- Turn on hardware acceleration in the settings of the browser, then reload the page.
- Try another browser, or a newer version of the same one.
- Add `?webgl` to the address to use WebGL2 even where WebGPU exists but does not work.

The desktop app does not build on Linux

The interface needs the development files of xkbcommon, Wayland and GTK 3. On Debian and Ubuntu:

```
sudo apt-get install -y libxkbcommon-dev libwayland-dev libgtk-3-dev
```

The interface

The Properties palette, the Project Browser or the command line has disappeared

They are closed with the × on their title, or from **View ▸ Windows ▸ User Interface**. Tick them again in **User Interface**. The **Properties** button of the contextual tab also shows the palette again.

What I type ends up at the command line

Whatever you type while no field is being edited goes to the command line: this is how typed shortcuts work. To type in a field of the Properties palette or of a dialog, click the field first.

A button is greyed

Some tools work only in the right view, and their tip says why. **Area Boundary Line** and **Area** need an open area plan: the tip says **Open an area plan first**. **Save View** needs an open 3D view; **Sheet Composition ▸ View** needs an open sheet; **Undo** and **Redo** are greyed when there is nothing to undo or redo.

`DL` starts a dimension instead of a detail line

`DL` is the short form of the linear dimension. To draw detail lines, use **Annotate ▸ Detail ▸ Detail line**, or type `detailline`.

Modelling

«no wall at that point»

A door or a window must be placed in a wall. Click on the wall itself, or give a point on its line at the command line.

A height set at the command line is enormous

At the command line a number without unit is in metres: `set Unconnected Height 2700` makes the wall 2700 m high. Undo with `Ctrl+Z` and write the unit: `2700mm` or `2.7m`. In the Properties palette a number without unit is in the project's units.

Files

Unsaved work is gone after New, Open or Sample project

These commands replace the current project without asking. Save before using them: the asterisk after the project's name in the title bar shows that there are unsaved changes.

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Open… in the browser does not show a file dialog

In the browser, drag the `.bimopen` file into the page: the command line says **Drag a .bimopen file into the window to open it**.

bimopen-cli prints its usage and stops

The arguments are not the ones it expects: it ends with code 2 and shows the usage. A command that fails ends with code 1 and a message saying which line failed. See Command line and MCP.

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